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(54) **INDICATION FOR NON-CAUSAL
DEMODULATION REFERENCE SIGNAL
CROSS-SLOT COMBINING**

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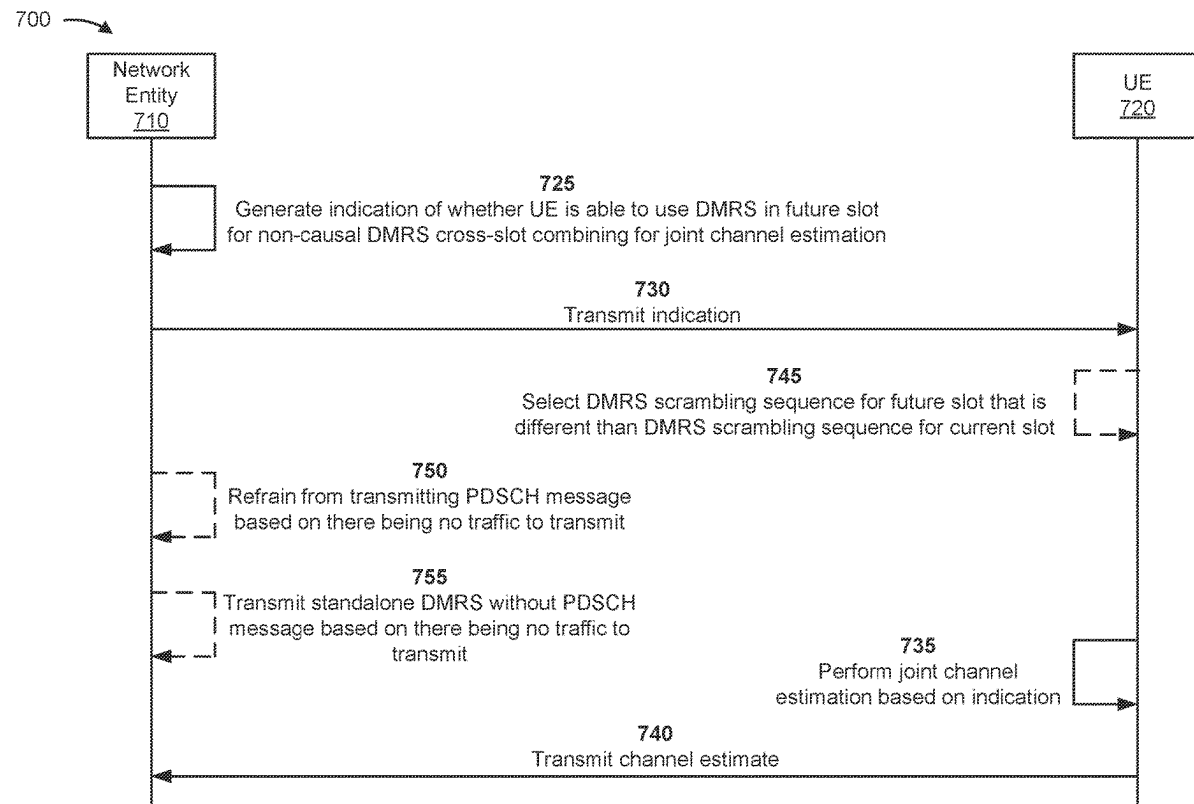
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

Various aspects of the present disclosure generally relate to wireless communication. In some aspects, a user equipment (UE) may receive an indication of whether the UE is able to use a demodulation reference signal (DMRS) in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The UE may perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication. Numerous other aspects are described.



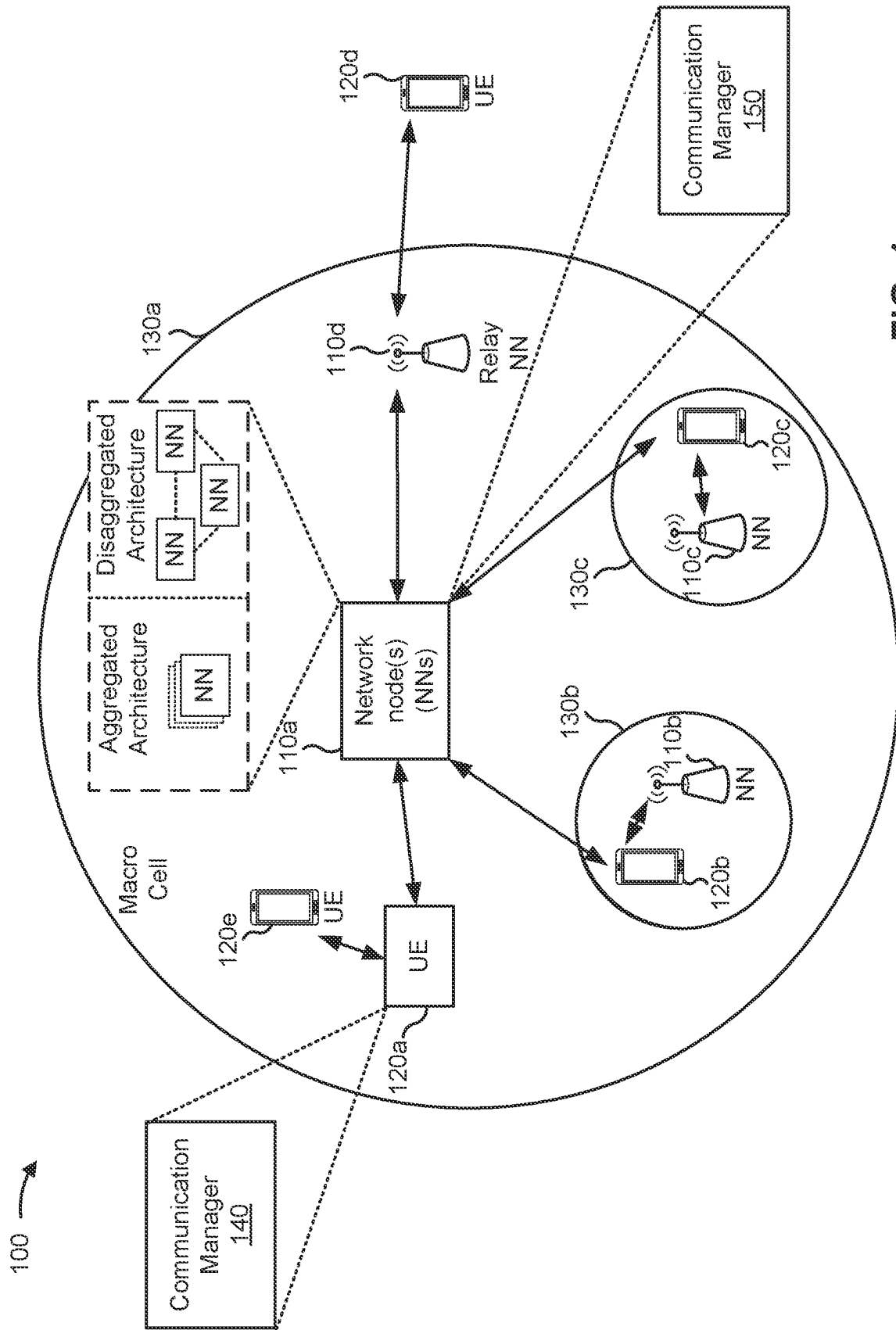


FIG. 1

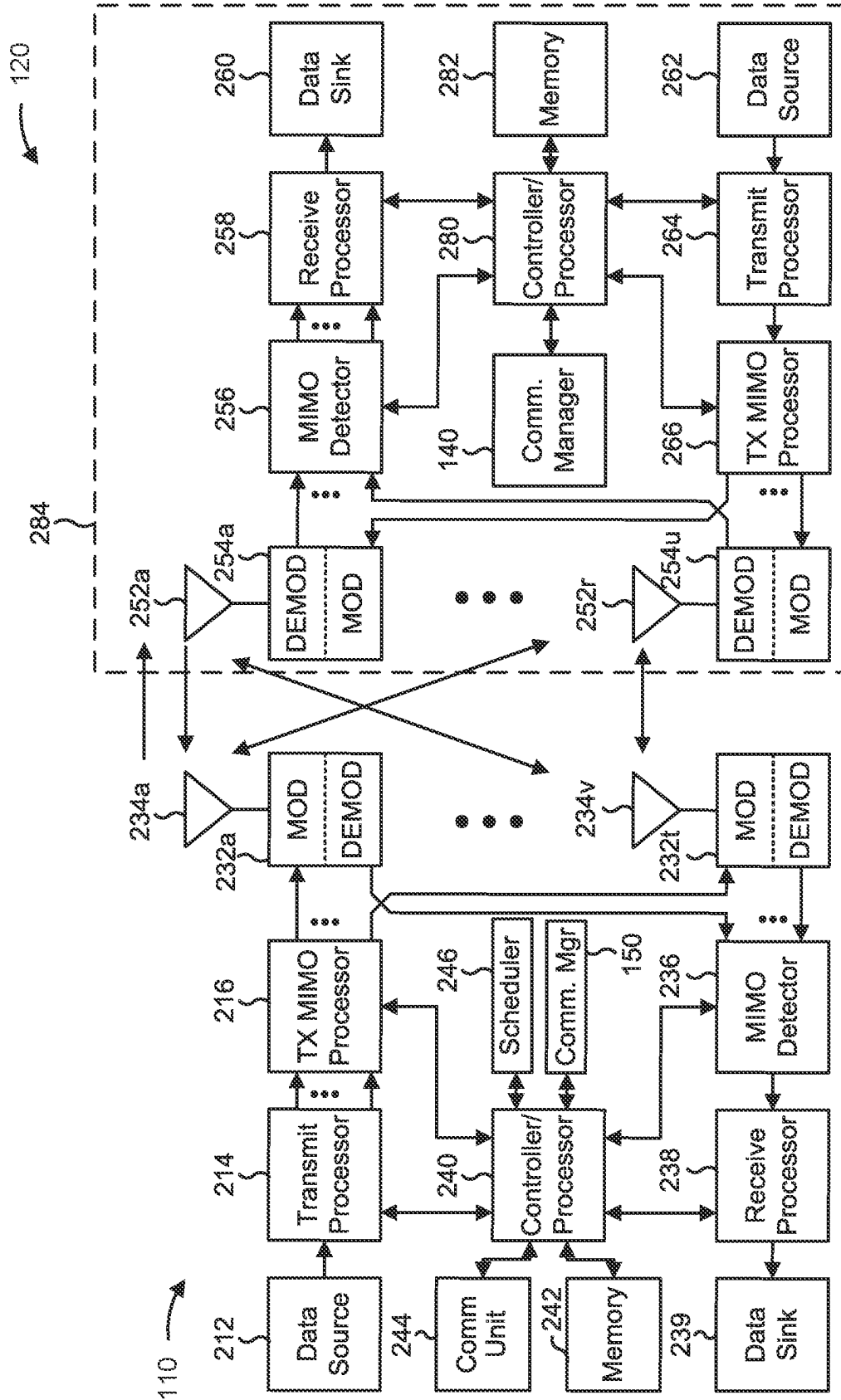


FIG. 2

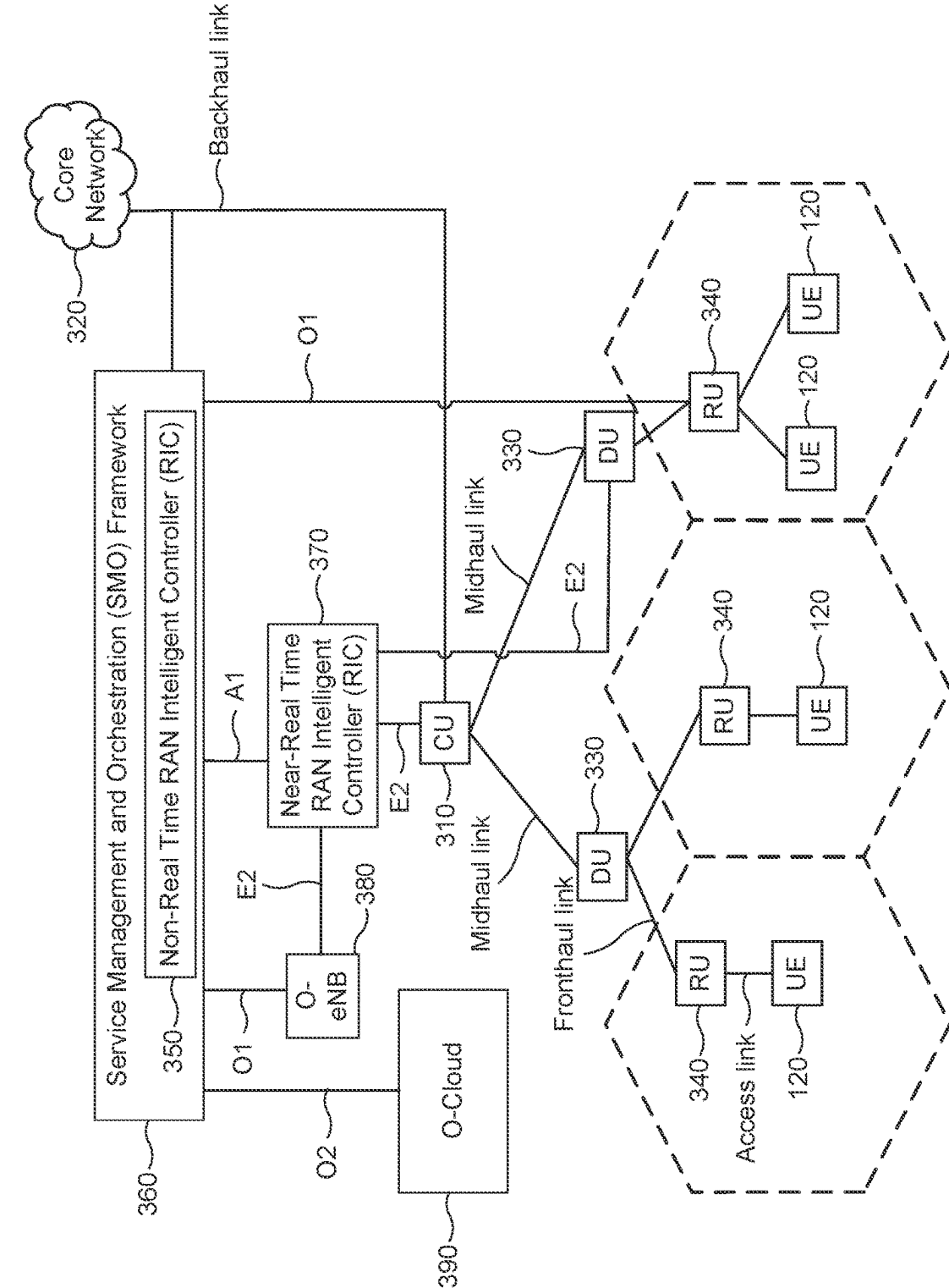


FIG. 3

400 →

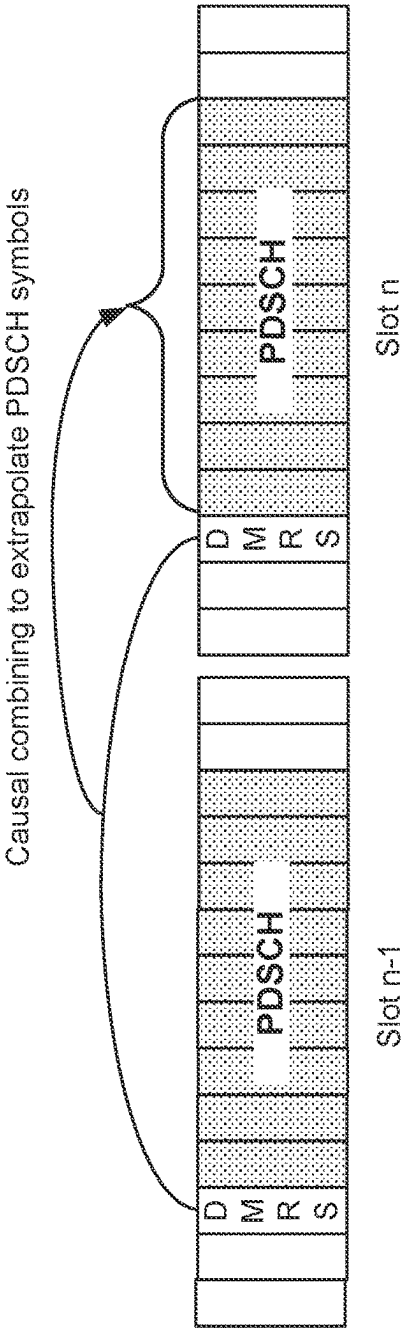


FIG. 4

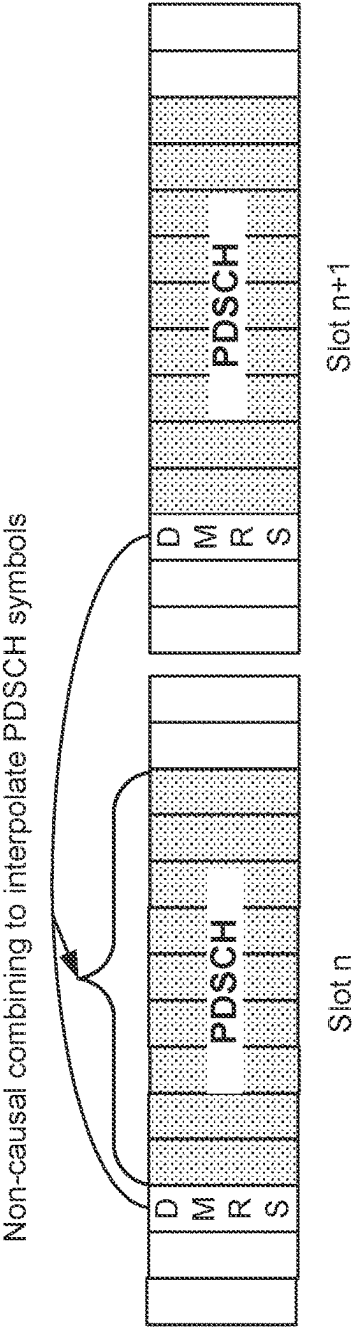


FIG. 5

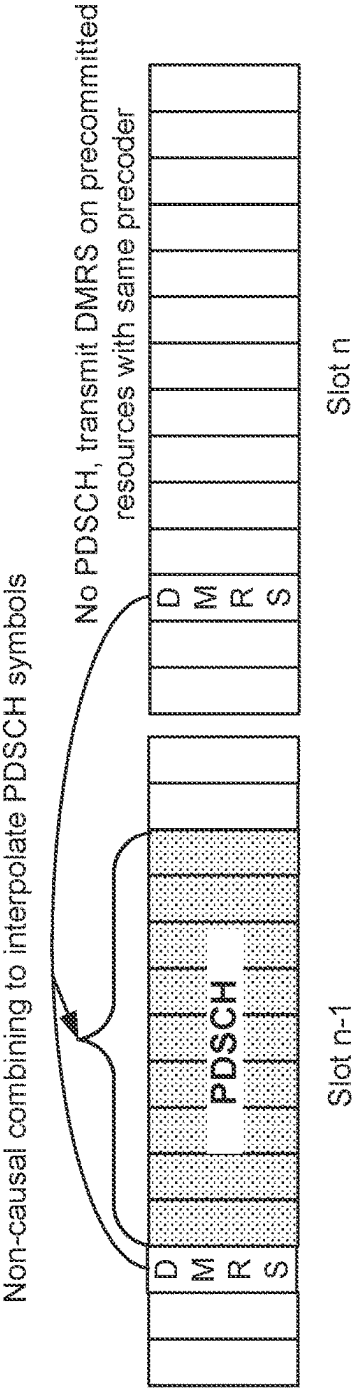


FIG. 6

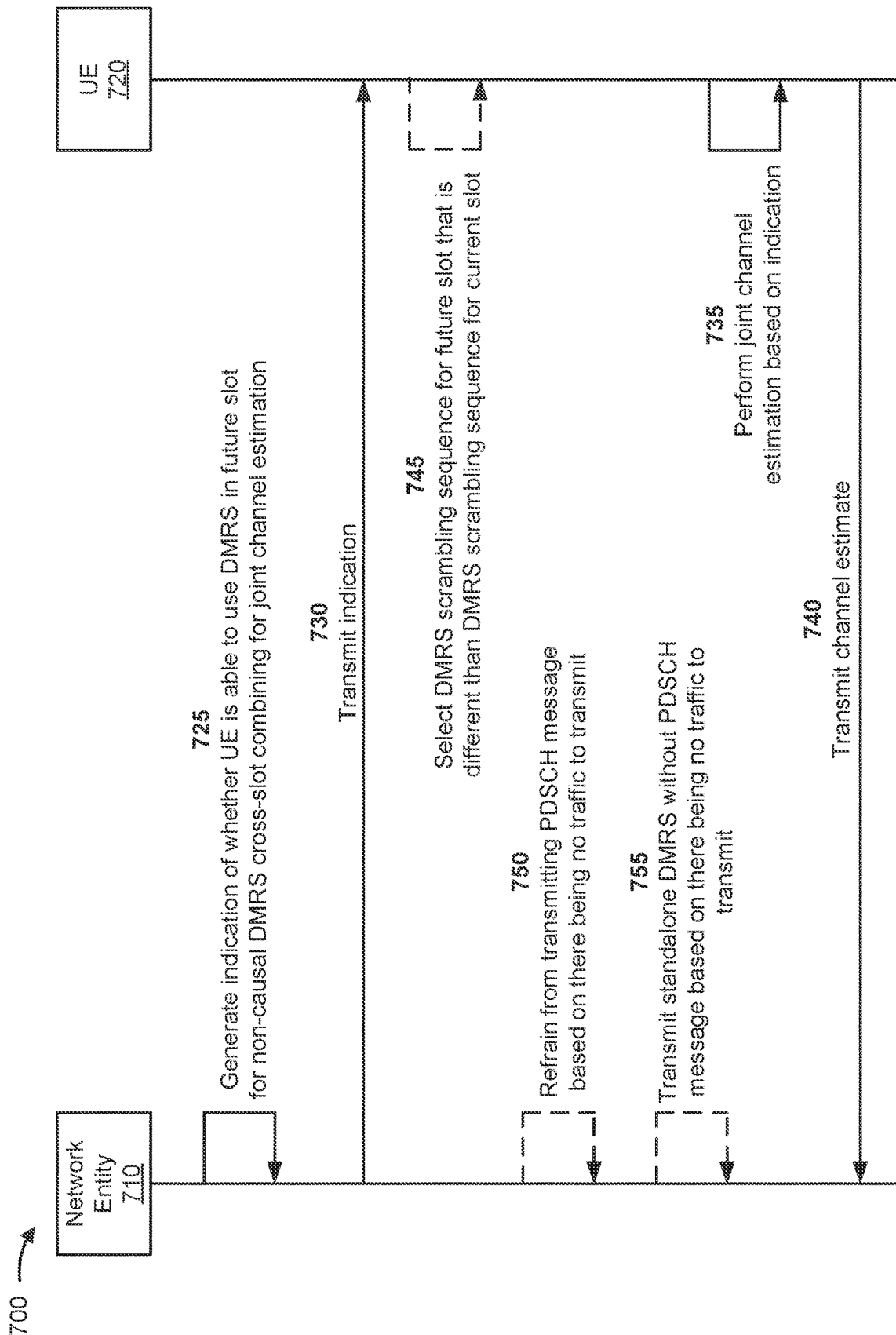


FIG. 7

800 →

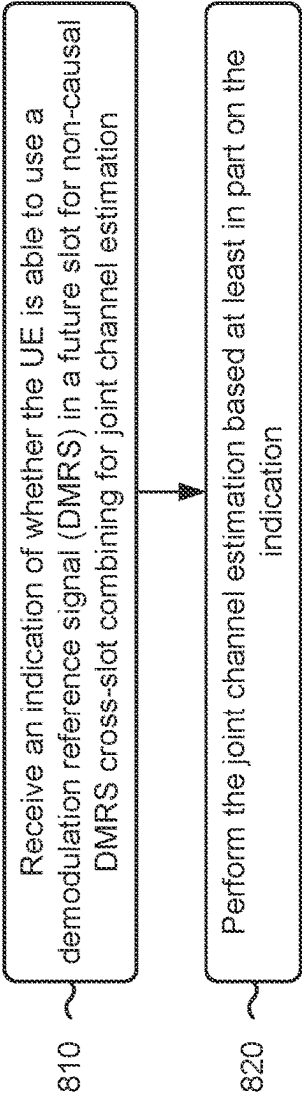


FIG. 8

900 →

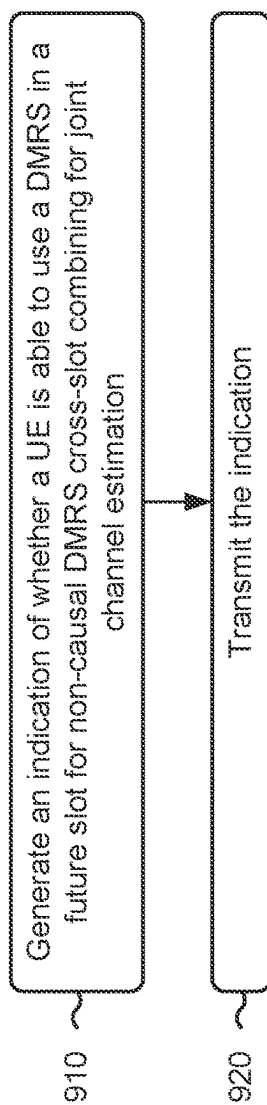


FIG. 9

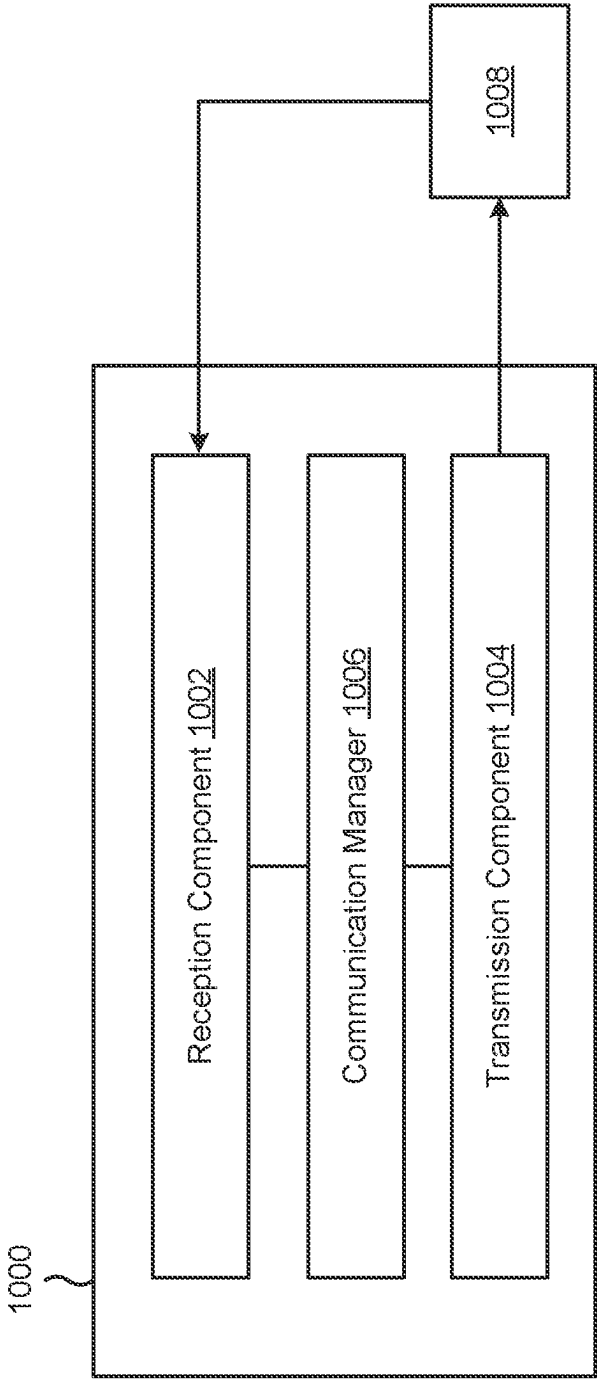


FIG. 10

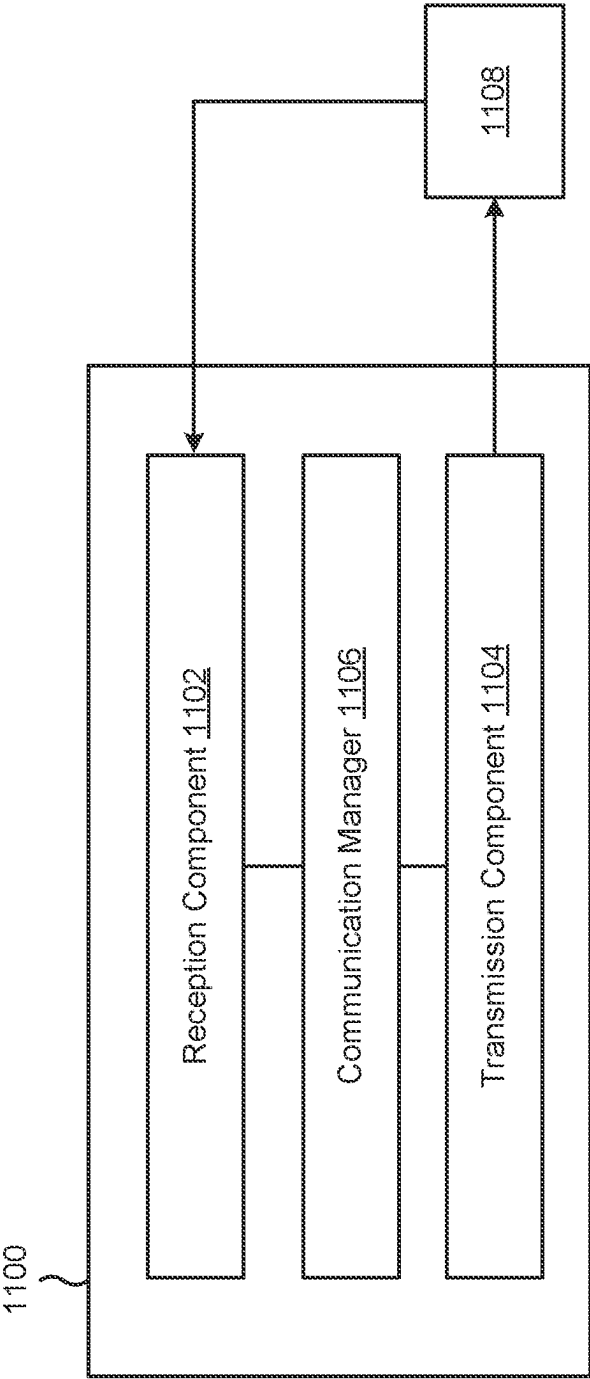


FIG. 11

INDICATION FOR NON-CAUSAL DEMODULATION REFERENCE SIGNAL CROSS-SLOT COMBINING

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

[0001] Aspects of the present disclosure generally relate to wireless communication and specifically relate to techniques, apparatuses, and methods for non-causal demodulation reference signal cross-slot combining.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Wireless communication systems are widely deployed to provide various services that may include carrying voice, text, messaging, video, data, and/or other traffic. The services may include unicast, multicast, and/or broadcast services, among other examples. Typical wireless communication systems may employ multiple-access radio access technologies (RATs) capable of supporting communication with multiple users by sharing available system resources (for example, time domain resources, frequency domain resources, spatial domain resources, and/or device transmit power, among other examples). Examples of such multiple-access RATs include code division multiple access (CDMA) systems, time division multiple access (TDMA) systems, frequency division multiple access (FDMA) systems, orthogonal frequency division multiple access (OFDMA) systems, single-carrier frequency division multiple access (SC-FDMA) systems, and time division synchronous code division multiple access (TD-SCDMA) systems.

[0003] The above multiple-access RATs have been adopted in various telecommunication standards to provide common protocols that enable different wireless communication devices to communicate on a municipal, national, regional, or global level. An example telecommunication standard is New Radio (NR). NR, which may also be referred to as 5G, is part of a continuous mobile broadband evolution promulgated by the Third Generation Partnership Project (3GPP). NR (and other mobile broadband evolutions beyond NR) may be designed to better support Internet of things (IoT) and reduced capability device deployments, industrial connectivity, millimeter wave (mmWave) expansion, licensed and unlicensed spectrum access, non-terrestrial network (NTN) deployment, sidelink and other device-to-device direct communication technologies (for example, cellular vehicle-to-everything (CV2X) communication), massive multiple-input multiple-output (MIMO), disaggregated network architectures and network topology expansions, multiple-subscriber implementations, high-precision positioning, and/or radio frequency (RF) sensing, among other examples. As the demand for mobile broadband access continues to increase, further improvements in NR may be implemented, and other radio access technologies such as 6G may be introduced, to further advance mobile broadband evolution.

SUMMARY

[0004] Some aspects described herein relate to a method of wireless communication performed by a user equipment (UE). The method may include receiving an indication of whether the UE is able to use a demodulation reference signal (DMRS) in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The

method may include performing the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication.

[0005] Some aspects described herein relate to a method of wireless communication performed by a network entity. The method may include generating an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The method may include transmitting the indication.

[0006] Some aspects described herein relate to an apparatus for wireless communication at a UE. The apparatus may include one or more memories and one or more processors coupled to the one or more memories. The one or more processors may be individually or collectively configured to receive an indication of whether the UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The one or more processors may be individually or collectively configured to perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication.

[0007] Some aspects described herein relate to an apparatus for wireless communication at a network entity. The apparatus may include one or more memories and one or more processors coupled to the one or more memories. The one or more processors may be individually or collectively configured to generate an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The one or more processors may be individually or collectively configured to transmit the indication.

[0008] Some aspects described herein relate to a non-transitory computer-readable medium that stores a set of instructions for wireless communication by a UE. The set of instructions, when executed by one or more processors of the UE, may cause the UE to receive an indication of whether the UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The set of instructions, when executed by one or more processors of the UE, may cause the UE to perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication.

[0009] Some aspects described herein relate to a non-transitory computer-readable medium that stores a set of instructions for wireless communication by a network entity. The set of instructions, when executed by one or more processors of the network entity, may cause the network entity to generate an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The set of instructions, when executed by one or more processors of the network entity, may cause the network entity to transmit the indication.

[0010] Some aspects described herein relate to an apparatus for wireless communication. The apparatus may include means for receiving an indication of whether the apparatus is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The apparatus may include means for performing the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication.

[0011] Some aspects described herein relate to an apparatus for wireless communication. The apparatus may include means for generating an indication of whether another apparatus is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for

non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The apparatus may include means for transmitting the indication.

[0012] Aspects of the present disclosure may generally be implemented by or as a method, apparatus, system, computer program product, non-transitory computer-readable medium, user equipment, base station, network node, network entity, wireless communication device, and/or processing system as substantially described with reference to, and as illustrated by, the specification and accompanying drawings.

[0013] The foregoing paragraphs of this section have broadly summarized some aspects of the present disclosure. These and additional aspects and associated advantages will be described hereinafter. The disclosed aspects may be used as a basis for modifying or designing other aspects for carrying out the same or similar purposes of the present disclosure. Such equivalent aspects do not depart from the scope of the appended claims. Characteristics of the aspects disclosed herein, both their organization and method of operation, together with associated advantages, will be better understood from the following description when considered in connection with the accompanying drawings.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0014] The appended drawings illustrate some aspects of the present disclosure, but are not limiting of the scope of the present disclosure because the description may enable other aspects. Each of the drawings is provided for purposes of illustration and description, and not as a definition of the limits of the claims. The same or similar reference numbers in different drawings may identify the same or similar elements.

[0015] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating an example of a wireless communication network in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0016] FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating an example network node in communication with an example user equipment (UE) in a wireless network in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating an example disaggregated base station architecture in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0018] FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating an example of causal cross-slot combining, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0019] FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating an example of non-causal cross-slot combining, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0020] FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating an example of non-causal cross-slot combining, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating an example associated with an indication of cross-slot demodulation reference signal combining, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0022] FIG. 8 is a diagram illustrating an example process performed, for example, at a UE or an apparatus of a UE, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0023] FIG. 9 is a diagram illustrating an example process performed, for example, at a network entity or an apparatus of a network entity, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0024] FIG. 10 is a diagram of an example apparatus for wireless communication, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0025] FIG. 11 is a diagram of an example apparatus for wireless communication, in accordance with the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0026] Various aspects of the present disclosure are described hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings. However, aspects of the present disclosure may be embodied in many different forms and is not to be construed as limited to any specific aspect illustrated by or described with reference to an accompanying drawing or otherwise presented in this disclosure. Rather, these aspects are provided so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of the disclosure to those skilled in the art. One skilled in the art may appreciate that the scope of the disclosure is intended to cover any aspect of the disclosure disclosed herein, whether implemented independently of or in combination with any other aspect of the disclosure. For example, an apparatus may be implemented or a method may be practiced using various combinations or quantities of the aspects set forth herein. In addition, the scope of the disclosure is intended to cover an apparatus having, or a method that is practiced using, other structures and/or functionalities in addition to or other than the structures and/or functionalities with which various aspects of the disclosure set forth herein may be practiced. Any aspect of the disclosure disclosed herein may be embodied by one or more elements of a claim.

[0027] Several aspects of telecommunication systems will now be presented with reference to various methods, operations, apparatuses, and techniques. These methods, operations, apparatuses, and techniques will be described in the following detailed description and illustrated in the accompanying drawings by various blocks, modules, components, circuits, steps, processes, or algorithms (collectively referred to as “elements”). These elements may be implemented using hardware, software, or a combination of hardware and software. Whether such elements are implemented as hardware or software depends upon the particular application and design constraints imposed on the overall system.

[0028] A user equipment (UE) may measure a demodulation reference signal (DMRS) in a downlink message to estimate a channel. The UE may obtain a more accurate channel estimate if the DMRS is jointly estimated with another DMRS of another transmission time interval (TTI). A TTI may include, for example, a slot. In some aspects, the UE may use causal cross-slot DMRS combining for joint channel estimation, in which the UE uses the DMRS and/or channel estimates from a previous slot $n-1$ with a DMRS of current slot n to jointly estimate the channel. However, for the first downlink slot of the burst, the receiving UE may not have the DMRS from a previous slot for combining. Furthermore, if the only DMRS is front loaded (e.g., placed in one of the first few symbols of a slot), combining with a front-loaded DMRS in the previous slot in causal cross-slot DMRS combining may lead to the extrapolation of channel estimates in the current TTI. This extrapolation may not be as accurate as interpolation, because extrapolation involves estimating an unknown value beyond the DMRSs, while interpolation involves estimating a value within the DMRSs.

[0029] In some aspects, a UE may perform non-causal cross-slot DMRS combining for joint channel estimation, which involves a DMRS of a future slot. The receiving UE may wait for the next front-loaded DMRS in the next slot and perform joint channel estimation, which for the current slot n may include time interpolation. In a high mobility scenario, the selection of non-causal over causal cross-slot DMRS combining may provide an additional gain.

[0030] For non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining, a UE may expect that there is a next slot for combining, and the UE may perform DMRS detection in the next slot to decide whether to combine DMRSs. However, this could seriously delay the UE physical downlink shared channel (PDSCH) decoding timeline. That is, the UE may expect to wait for the DMRS in the next slot before completing the joint channel estimation and the PDSCH decoding. This could adversely consume the processing timing budget of the UE.

[0031] Various aspects relate generally to channel estimation. Some aspects more specifically relate to a network entity indicating whether non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is possible with the next TTI (e.g., next slot). The network entity may also indicate combinable DMRS resources in the next slot. If the network entity indicates that cross-slot DMRS combining is possible, the network entity may commit to scheduling the next slot with the same precoding and/or the same transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state.

[0032] In some aspects, the network entity may provide an indication (e.g., in downlink control information (DCI)) of whether non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is possible. The DCI may indicate that the UE is able to perform non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining. That is, the indication is not for a capability of the UE, but whether the UE is to expect to be able to perform non-causal DMRS cross-slot DMRS combining. The DCI may further indicate a port number, a frequency domain resource allocation (FDRA), and/or which DMRS symbols in the next slot are combinable for non-causal cross-slot DMRS combining. Based at least in part on the indication, the UE may decide whether to delay the channel estimation, delay a PDSCH demapper (that demaps PDSCH symbols to bits), and/or to delay a decoding timeline.

[0033] Particular aspects of the subject matter described in this disclosure can be implemented to realize one or more of the following potential advantages. By indicating whether DMRS combining is possible, the UE may perform joint channel estimation with cross-slot DMRS combining when doing so is worth the use of the resources. As a result, latency is reduced and/or the UE processing timeline is not negatively impacted.

[0034] Multiple-access radio access technologies (RATs) have been adopted in various telecommunication standards to provide common protocols that enable wireless communication devices to communicate on a municipal, enterprise, national, regional, or global level. For example, 5G New Radio (NR) is part of a continuous mobile broadband evolution promulgated by the Third Generation Partnership Project (3GPP). 5G NR supports various technologies and use cases including enhanced mobile broadband (eMBB), ultra-reliable low-latency communication (URLLC), massive machine-type communication (mMTC), millimeter wave (mmWave) technology, beamforming, network slic-

ing, edge computing, Internet of Things (IoT) connectivity and management, and network function virtualization (NFV).

[0035] As the demand for broadband access increases and as technologies supported by wireless communication networks evolve, further technological improvements may be adopted in or implemented for 5G NR or future RATs, such as 6G, to further advance the evolution of wireless communication for a wide variety of existing and new use cases and applications. Such technological improvements may be associated with new frequency band expansion, licensed and unlicensed spectrum access, overlapping spectrum use, small cell deployments, non-terrestrial network (NTN) deployments, disaggregated network architectures and network topology expansion, device aggregation, advanced duplex communication, sidelink and other device-to-device direct communication, IoT (including passive or ambient IoT) networks, reduced capability (RedCap) UE functionality, industrial connectivity, multiple-subscriber implementations, high-precision positioning, radio frequency (RF) sensing, and/or artificial intelligence or machine learning (AI/ML), among other examples. These technological improvements may support use cases such as wireless backhauls, wireless data centers, extended reality (XR) and metaverse applications, meta services for supporting vehicle connectivity, holographic and mixed reality communication, autonomous and collaborative robots, vehicle platooning and cooperative maneuvering, sensing networks, gesture monitoring, human-brain interfacing, digital twin applications, asset management, and universal coverage applications using non-terrestrial and/or aerial platforms, among other examples. The methods, operations, apparatuses, and techniques described herein may enable one or more of the foregoing technologies and/or support one or more of the foregoing use cases.

[0036] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating an example of a wireless communication network **100** in accordance with the present disclosure. The wireless communication network **100** may be or may include elements of a 5G (or NR) network or a 6G network, among other examples. The wireless communication network **100** may include multiple network nodes **110**, shown as a network node (NN) **110a**, a network node **110b**, a network node **110c**, and a network node **110d**. The network nodes **110** may support communications with multiple UEs **120**, shown as a UE **120a**, a UE **120b**, a UE **120c**, a UE **120d**, and a UE **120e**.

[0037] The network nodes **110** and the UEs **120** of the wireless communication network **100** may communicate using the electromagnetic spectrum, which may be subdivided by frequency or wavelength into various classes, bands, carriers, and/or channels. For example, devices of the wireless communication network **100** may communicate using one or more operating bands. In some aspects, multiple wireless networks **100** may be deployed in a given geographic area. Each wireless communication network **100** may support a particular RAT (which may also be referred to as an air interface) and may operate on one or more carrier frequencies in one or more frequency ranges. Examples of RATs include a 4G RAT, a 5G/NR RAT, and/or a 6G RAT, among other examples. In some examples, when multiple RATs are deployed in a given geographic area, each RAT in the geographic area may operate on different frequencies to avoid interference with one another.

[0038] Various operating bands have been defined as frequency range designations FR1 (410 MHz through 7.125 GHz), FR2 (24.25 GHz through 52.6 GHz), FR3 (7.125 GHz through 24.25 GHz), FR4a or FR4-1 (52.6 GHz through 71 GHz), FR4 (52.6 GHz through 114.25 GHz), and FR5 (114.25 GHz through 300 GHz). Although a portion of FR1 is greater than 6 GHz, FR1 is often referred to (interchangeably) as a “Sub-6 GHz” band in some documents and articles. Similarly, FR2 is often referred to (interchangeably) as a “millimeter wave” band in some documents and articles, despite being different than the extremely high frequency (EHF) band (30 GHz through 300 GHz), which is identified by the International Telecommunications Union (ITU) as a “millimeter wave” band. The frequencies between FR1 and FR2 are often referred to as mid-band frequencies, which include FR3. Frequency bands falling within FR3 may inherit FR1 characteristics or FR2 characteristics, and thus may effectively extend features of FR1 or FR2 into mid-band frequencies. Thus, “sub-6 GHz,” if used herein, may broadly refer to frequencies that are less than 6 GHz, that are within FR1, and/or that are included in mid-band frequencies. Similarly, the term “millimeter wave,” if used herein, may broadly refer to frequencies that are included in mid-band frequencies, that are within FR2, FR4, FR4-a or FR4-1, or FR5, and/or that are within the EHF band. Higher frequency bands may extend 5G NR operation, 6G operation, and/or other RATs beyond 52.6 GHz. For example, each of FR4a, FR4-1, FR4, and FR5 falls within the EHF band. In some examples, the wireless communication network **100** may implement dynamic spectrum sharing (DSS), in which multiple RATs (for example, 4G/LTE and 5G/NR) are implemented with dynamic bandwidth allocation (for example, based on user demand) in a single frequency band. It is contemplated that the frequencies included in these operating bands (for example, FR1, FR2, FR3, FR4, FR4-a, FR4-1, and/or FR5) may be modified, and techniques described herein may be applicable to those modified frequency ranges.

[0039] A network node **110** may include one or more devices, components, or systems that enable communication between a UE **120** and one or more devices, components, or systems of the wireless communication network **100**. A network node **110** may be, may include, or may also be referred to as an NR network node, a 5G network node, a 6G network node, a Node B, an eNB, a gNB, an access point (AP), a transmission reception point (TRP), a mobility element, a core, a network entity, a network element, a network equipment, and/or another type of device, component, or system included in a radio access network (RAN).

[0040] A network node **110** may be implemented as a single physical node (for example, a single physical structure) or may be implemented as two or more physical nodes (for example, two or more distinct physical structures). For example, a network node **110** may be a device or system that implements part of a radio protocol stack, a device or system that implements a full radio protocol stack (such as a full gNB protocol stack), or a collection of devices or systems that collectively implement the full radio protocol stack. For example, and as shown, a network node **110** may be an aggregated network node (having an aggregated architecture), meaning that the network node **110** may implement a full radio protocol stack that is physically and logically integrated within a single node (for example, a single physical structure) in the wireless communication network

100. For example, an aggregated network node **110** may consist of a single standalone base station or a single TRP that uses a full radio protocol stack to enable or facilitate communication between a UE **120** and a core network of the wireless communication network **100**.

[0041] Alternatively, and as also shown, a network node **110** may be a disaggregated network node (sometimes referred to as a disaggregated base station), meaning that the network node **110** may implement a radio protocol stack that is physically distributed and/or logically distributed among two or more nodes in the same geographic location or in different geographic locations. For example, a disaggregated network node may have a disaggregated architecture. In some deployments, disaggregated network nodes **110** may be used in an integrated access and backhaul (IAB) network, in an open radio access network (O-RAN) (such as a network configuration in compliance with the O-RAN Alliance), or in a virtualized radio access network (vRAN), also known as a cloud radio access network (C-RAN), to facilitate scaling by separating base station functionality into multiple units that can be individually deployed.

[0042] The network nodes **110** of the wireless communication network **100** may include one or more central units (CUs), one or more distributed units (DUs), and/or one or more radio units (RUs). A CU may host one or more higher layer control functions, such as radio resource control (RRC) functions, packet data convergence protocol (PDCP) functions, and/or service data adaptation protocol (SDAP) functions, among other examples. A DU may host one or more of a radio link control (RLC) layer, a medium access control (MAC) layer, and/or one or more higher physical (PHY) layers depending, at least in part, on a functional split, such as a functional split defined by the 3GPP. In some examples, a DU also may host one or more lower PHY layer functions, such as a fast Fourier transform (FFT), an inverse FFT (iFFT), beamforming, physical random access channel (PRACH) extraction and filtering, and/or scheduling of resources for one or more UEs **120**, among other examples. An RU may host RF processing functions or lower PHY layer functions, such as an FFT, an iFFT, beamforming, or PRACH extraction and filtering, among other examples, according to a functional split, such as a lower layer functional split. In such an architecture, each RU can be operated to handle over the air (OTA) communication with one or more UEs.

[0043] In some aspects, a single network node **110** may include a combination of one or more CUs, one or more DUs, and/or one or more RUs. Additionally or alternatively, a network node **110** may include one or more Near-Real Time (Near-RT) RAN Intelligent Controllers (RICs) and/or one or more Non-Real Time (Non-RT) RICs. In some examples, a CU, a DU, and/or an RU may be implemented as a virtual unit, such as a virtual central unit (VCU), a virtual distributed unit (VDU), or a virtual radio unit (VRU), among other examples. A virtual unit may be implemented as a virtual network function, such as associated with a cloud deployment.

[0044] Some network nodes **110** (for example, a base station, an RU, or a TRP) may provide communication coverage for a particular geographic area. In the 3GPP, the term “cell” can refer to a coverage area of a network node **110** or to a network node **110** itself, depending on the context in which the term is used. A network node **110** may support one or multiple (for example, three) cells. In some examples,

a network node **110** may provide communication coverage for a macro cell, a pico cell, a femto cell, or another type of cell. A macro cell may cover a relatively large geographic area (for example, several kilometers in radius) and may allow unrestricted access by UEs **120** with service subscriptions. A pico cell may cover a relatively small geographic area and may allow unrestricted access by UEs **120** with service subscriptions. A femto cell may cover a relatively small geographic area (for example, a home) and may allow restricted access by UEs **120** having association with the femto cell (for example, UEs **120** in a closed subscriber group (CSG)). A network node **110** for a macro cell may be referred to as a macro network node. A network node **110** for a pico cell may be referred to as a pico network node. A network node **110** for a femto cell may be referred to as a femto network node or an in-home network node. In some examples, a cell may not necessarily be stationary. For example, the geographic area of the cell may move according to the location of an associated mobile network node **110** (for example, a train, a satellite base station, an unmanned aerial vehicle, or an NTN network node).

[0045] The wireless communication network **100** may be a heterogeneous network that includes network nodes **110** of different types, such as macro network nodes, pico network nodes, femto network nodes, relay network nodes, aggregated network nodes, and/or disaggregated network nodes, among other examples. In the example shown in FIG. 1, the network node **110a** may be a macro network node for a macro cell **130a**, the network node **110b** may be a pico network node for a pico cell **130b**, and the network node **110c** may be a femto network node for a femto cell **130c**. Various different types of network nodes **110** may generally transmit at different power levels, serve different coverage areas, and/or have different impacts on interference in the wireless communication network **100** than other types of network nodes **110**. For example, macro network nodes may have a high transmit power level (for example, 5 to 40 watts), whereas pico network nodes, femto network nodes, and relay network nodes may have lower transmit power levels (for example, 0.1 to 2 watts).

[0046] In some examples, a network node **110** may be, may include, or may operate as an RU, a TRP, or a base station that communicates with one or more UEs **120** via a radio access link (which may be referred to as a “Uu” link). The radio access link may include a downlink and an uplink. “Downlink” (or “DL”) refers to a communication direction from a network node **110** to a UE **120**, and “uplink” (or “UL”) refers to a communication direction from a UE **120** to a network node **110**. Downlink channels may include one or more control channels and one or more data channels. A downlink control channel may be used to transmit downlink control information (DCI) (for example, scheduling information, reference signals, and/or configuration information) from a network node **110** to a UE **120**. A downlink data channel may be used to transmit downlink data (for example, user data associated with a UE **120**) from a network node **110** to a UE **120**. Downlink control channels may include one or more physical downlink control channels (PDCCHs), and downlink data channels may include one or more physical downlink shared channels (PDSCHs). Uplink channels may similarly include one or more control channels and one or more data channels. An uplink control channel may be used to transmit uplink control information (UCI) (for example, reference signals and/or feedback cor-

responding to one or more downlink transmissions) from a UE **120** to a network node **110**. An uplink data channel may be used to transmit uplink data (for example, user data associated with a UE **120**) from a UE **120** to a network node **110**. Uplink control channels may include one or more physical uplink control channels (PUCCHs), and uplink data channels may include one or more physical uplink shared channels (PUSCHs). The downlink and the uplink may each include a set of resources on which the network node **110** and the UE **120** may communicate.

[0047] Downlink and uplink resources may include time domain resources (frames, subframes, slots, and/or symbols), frequency domain resources (frequency bands, component carriers, subcarriers, resource blocks, and/or resource elements), and/or spatial domain resources (particular transmit directions and/or beam parameters). Frequency domain resources of some bands may be subdivided into bandwidth parts (BWPs). A BWP may be a continuous block of frequency domain resources (for example, a continuous block of resource blocks) that are allocated for one or more UEs **120**. A UE **120** may be configured with both an uplink BWP and a downlink BWP (where the uplink BWP and the downlink BWP may be the same BWP or different BWPs). A BWP may be dynamically configured (for example, by a network node **110** transmitting a DCI configuration to the one or more UEs **120**) and/or reconfigured, which means that a BWP can be adjusted in real-time (or near-real-time) based on changing network conditions in the wireless communication network **100** and/or based on the specific requirements of the one or more UEs **120**. This enables more efficient use of the available frequency domain resources in the wireless communication network **100** because fewer frequency domain resources may be allocated to a BWP for a UE **120** (which may reduce the quantity of frequency domain resources that a UE **120** is required to monitor), leaving more frequency domain resources to be spread across multiple UEs **120**. Thus, BWPs may also assist in the implementation of lower-capability UEs **120** by facilitating the configuration of smaller bandwidths for communication by such UEs **120**.

[0048] As described above, in some aspects, the wireless communication network **100** may be, may include, or may be included in, an IAB network. In an IAB network, at least one network node **110** is an anchor network node that communicates with a core network. An anchor network node **110** may also be referred to as an IAB donor (or “IAB-donor”). The anchor network node **110** may connect to the core network via a wired backhaul link. For example, an Ng interface of the anchor network node **110** may terminate at the core network. Additionally or alternatively, an anchor network node **110** may connect to one or more devices of the core network that provide a core access and mobility management function (AMF). An IAB network also generally includes multiple non-anchor network nodes **110**, which may also be referred to as relay network nodes or simply as IAB nodes (or “IAB-nodes”). Each non-anchor network node **110** may communicate directly with the anchor network node **110** via a wireless backhaul link to access the core network, or may communicate indirectly with the anchor network node **110** via one or more other non-anchor network nodes **110** and associated wireless backhaul links that form a backhaul path to the core network. Some anchor network node **110** or other non-anchor network node **110** may also communicate directly with one or more UEs **120**

via wireless access links that carry access traffic. In some examples, network resources for wireless communication (such as time resources, frequency resources, and/or spatial resources) may be shared between access links and backhaul links.

[0049] In some examples, any network node **110** that relays communications may be referred to as a relay network node, a relay station, or simply as a relay. A relay may receive a transmission of a communication from an upstream station (for example, another network node **110** or a UE **120**) and transmit the communication to a downstream station (for example, a UE **120** or another network node **110**). In this case, the wireless communication network **100** may include or be referred to as a “multi-hop network.” In the example shown in FIG. 1, the network node **110d** (for example, a relay network node) may communicate with the network node **110a** (for example, a macro network node) and the UE **120d** in order to facilitate communication between the network node **110a** and the UE **120d**. Additionally or alternatively, a UE **120** may be or may operate as a relay station that can relay transmissions to or from other UEs **120**. A UE **120** that relays communications may be referred to as a UE relay or a relay UE, among other examples.

[0050] The UEs **120** may be physically dispersed throughout the wireless communication network **100**, and each UE **120** may be stationary or mobile. A UE **120** may be, may include, or may be included in an access terminal, another terminal, a mobile station, or a subscriber unit. A UE **120** may be, include, or be coupled with a cellular phone (for example, a smart phone), a personal digital assistant (PDA), a wireless modem, a wireless communication device, a handheld device, a laptop computer, a cordless phone, a wireless local loop (WLL) station, a tablet, a camera, a gaming device, a netbook, a smartbook, an ultrabook, a medical device, a biometric device, a wearable device (for example, a smart watch, smart clothing, smart glasses, a smart wristband, and/or smart jewelry, such as a smart ring or a smart bracelet), an entertainment device (for example, a music device, a video device, and/or a satellite radio), an XR device, a vehicular component or sensor, a smart meter or sensor, industrial manufacturing equipment, a Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) device (such as a Global Positioning System device or another type of positioning device), a UE function of a network node, and/or any other suitable device or function that may communicate via a wireless medium.

[0051] A UE **120** and/or a network node **110** may include one or more chips, system-on-chips (SoCs), chipsets, packages, or devices that individually or collectively constitute or comprise a processing system. The processing system includes processor (or “processing”) circuitry in the form of one or multiple processors, microprocessors, processing units (such as central processing units (CPUs), graphics processing units (GPUs), neural processing units (NPUs) and/or digital signal processors (DSPs)), processing blocks, application-specific integrated circuits (ASIC), programmable logic devices (PLDs) (such as field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs)), or other discrete gate or transistor logic or circuitry (all of which may be generally referred to herein individually as “processors” or collectively as “the processor” or “the processor circuitry”). One or more of the processors may be individually or collectively configurable or configured to perform various functions or operations

described herein. A group of processors collectively configurable or configured to perform a set of functions may include a first processor configurable or configured to perform a first function of the set and a second processor configurable or configured to perform a second function of the set, or may include the group of processors all being configured or configurable to perform the set of functions.

[0052] The processing system may further include memory circuitry in the form of one or more memory devices, memory blocks, memory elements or other discrete gate or transistor logic or circuitry, each of which may include tangible storage media such as random-access memory (RAM) or read-only memory (ROM), or combinations thereof (all of which may be generally referred to herein individually as “memories” or collectively as “the memory” or “the memory circuitry”). One or more of the memories may be coupled (for example, operatively coupled, communicatively coupled, electronically coupled, or electrically coupled) with one or more of the processors and may individually or collectively store processor-executable code (such as software) that, when executed by one or more of the processors, may configure one or more of the processors to perform various functions or operations described herein. Additionally or alternatively, in some examples, one or more of the processors may be preconfigured to perform various functions or operations described herein without requiring configuration by software. The processing system may further include or be coupled with one or more modems (such as a Wi-Fi (for example, IEEE compliant) modem or a cellular (for example, 3GPP 4G LTE, 5G, or 6G compliant) modem). In some implementations, one or more processors of the processing system include or implement one or more of the modems. The processing system may further include or be coupled with multiple radios (collectively “the radio”), multiple RF chains, or multiple transceivers, each of which may in turn be coupled with one or more of multiple antennas. In some implementations, one or more processors of the processing system include or implement one or more of the radios, RF chains or transceivers. The UE **120** may include or may be included in a housing that houses components associated with the UE **120** including the processing system.

[0053] Some UEs **120** may be considered machine-type communication (MTC) UEs, evolved or enhanced machine-type communication (eMTC), UEs, further enhanced eMTC (feMTC) UEs, or enhanced feMTC (efeMTC) UEs, or further evolutions thereof, all of which may be simply referred to as “MTC UEs”). An MTC UE may be, may include, or may be included in or coupled with a robot, an uncrewed aerial vehicle, a remote device, a sensor, a meter, a monitor, and/or a location tag. Some UEs **120** may be considered IoT devices and/or may be implemented as NB-IoT (narrowband IoT) devices. An IoT UE or NB-IoT device may be, may include, or may be included in or coupled with an industrial machine, an appliance, a refrigerator, a doorbell camera device, a home automation device, and/or a light fixture, among other examples. Some UEs **120** may be considered Customer Premises Equipment, which may include telecommunications devices that are installed at a customer location (such as a home or office) to enable access to a service provider’s network (such as included in or in communication with the wireless communication network **100**).

[0054] Some UEs 120 may be classified according to different categories in association with different complexities and/or different capabilities. UEs 120 in a first category may facilitate massive IoT in the wireless communication network 100, and may offer low complexity and/or cost relative to UEs 120 in a second category. UEs 120 in a second category may include mission-critical IoT devices, legacy UEs, baseline UEs, high-tier UEs, advanced UEs, full-capability UEs, and/or premium UEs that are capable of URLLC, enhanced mobile broadband (eMBB), and/or precise positioning in the wireless communication network 100, among other examples. A third category of UEs 120 may have mid-tier complexity and/or capability (for example, a capability between UEs 120 of the first category and UEs 120 of the second category). A UE 120 of the third category may be referred to as a reduced capacity UE (“RedCap UE”), a mid-tier UE, an NR-Light UE, and/or an NR-Lite UE, among other examples. RedCap UEs may bridge a gap between the capability and complexity of NB-IoT devices and/or eMTC UEs, and mission-critical IoT devices and/or premium UEs. RedCap UEs may include, for example, wearable devices, IoT devices, industrial sensors, and/or cameras that are associated with a limited bandwidth, power capacity, and/or transmission range, among other examples. RedCap UEs may support healthcare environments, building automation, electrical distribution, process automation, transport and logistics, and/or smart city deployments, among other examples.

[0055] In some examples, two or more UEs 120 (for example, shown as UE 120a and UE 120e) may communicate directly with one another using sidelink communications (for example, without communicating by way of a network node 110 as an intermediary). As an example, the UE 120a may directly transmit data, control information, or other signaling as a sidelink communication to the UE 120e. This is in contrast to, for example, the UE 120a first transmitting data in an UL communication to a network node 110, which then transmits the data to the UE 120e in a DL communication. In various examples, the UEs 120 may transmit and receive sidelink communications using peer-to-peer (P2P) communication protocols, device-to-device (D2D) communication protocols, vehicle-to-everything (V2X) communication protocols (which may include vehicle-to-vehicle (V2V) protocols, vehicle-to-infrastructure (V2I) protocols, and/or vehicle-to-pedestrian (V2P) protocols), and/or mesh network communication protocols. In some deployments and configurations, a network node 110 may schedule and/or allocate resources for sidelink communications between UEs 120 in the wireless communication network 100. In some other deployments and configurations, a UE 120 (instead of a network node 110) may perform, or collaborate or negotiate with one or more other UEs to perform, scheduling operations, resource selection operations, and/or other operations for sidelink communications.

[0056] In various examples, some of the network nodes 110 and the UEs 120 of the wireless communication network 100 may be configured for full-duplex operation in addition to half-duplex operation. A network node 110 or a UE 120 operating in a half-duplex mode may perform only one of transmission or reception during particular time resources, such as during particular slots, symbols, or other time periods. Half-duplex operation may involve time-division duplexing (TDD), in which DL transmissions of the network

node 110 and UL transmissions of the UE 120 do not occur in the same time resources (that is, the transmissions do not overlap in time). In contrast, a network node 110 or a UE 120 operating in a full-duplex mode can transmit and receive communications concurrently (for example, in the same time resources). By operating in a full-duplex mode, network nodes 110 and/or UEs 120 may generally increase the capacity of the network and the radio access link. In some examples, full-duplex operation may involve frequency-division duplexing (FDD), in which DL transmissions of the network node 110 are performed in a first frequency band or on a first component carrier and transmissions of the UE 120 are performed in a second frequency band or on a second component carrier different than the first frequency band or the first component carrier, respectively. In some examples, full-duplex operation may be enabled for a UE 120 but not for a network node 110. For example, a UE 120 may simultaneously transmit an UL transmission to a first network node 110 and receive a DL transmission from a second network node 110 in the same time resources. In some other examples, full-duplex operation may be enabled for a network node 110 but not for a UE 120. For example, a network node 110 may simultaneously transmit a DL transmission to a first UE 120 and receive an UL transmission from a second UE 120 in the same time resources. In some other examples, full-duplex operation may be enabled for both a network node 110 and a UE 120.

[0057] In some examples, the UEs 120 and the network nodes 110 may perform MIMO communication. “MIMO” generally refers to transmitting or receiving multiple signals (such as multiple layers or multiple data streams) simultaneously over the same time and frequency resources. MIMO techniques generally exploit multipath propagation. MIMO may be implemented using various spatial processing or spatial multiplexing operations. In some examples, MIMO may support simultaneous transmission to multiple receivers, referred to as multi-user MIMO (MU-MIMO). Some RATs may employ advanced MIMO techniques, such as mTRP operation (including redundant transmission or reception on multiple TRPs), reciprocity in the time domain or the frequency domain, single-frequency-network (SFN) transmission, or non-coherent joint transmission (NCJT).

[0058] In some aspects, a UE (e.g., a UE 120) may include a communication manager 140. As described in more detail elsewhere herein, the communication manager 140 may receive an indication of whether the UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The communication manager 140 may perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication. Additionally, or alternatively, the communication manager 140 may perform one or more other operations described herein.

[0059] In some aspects, a network entity (e.g., a network node 110) may include a communication manager 150. As described in more detail elsewhere herein, the communication manager 150 may generate an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The communication manager 150 may transmit the indication. Additionally, or alternatively, the communication manager 150 may perform one or more other operations described herein.

[0060] As indicated above, FIG. 1 is provided as an example. Other examples may differ from what is described with regard to FIG. 1.

[0061] FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating an example network node 110 in communication with an example UE 120 in a wireless network in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0062] As shown in FIG. 2, the network node 110 may include a data source 212, a transmit processor 214, a transmit (TX) MIMO processor 216, a set of modems 232 (shown as 232a through 232t, where $t \geq 1$), a set of antennas 234 (shown as 234a through 234v, where $v \geq 1$), a MIMO detector 236, a receive processor 238, a data sink 239, a controller/processor 240, a memory 242, a communication unit 244, a scheduler 246, and/or a communication manager 150, among other examples. In some configurations, one or a combination of the antenna(s) 234, the modem(s) 232, the MIMO detector 236, the receive processor 238, the transmit processor 214, and/or the TX MIMO processor 216 may be included in a transceiver of the network node 110. The transceiver may be under control of and used by one or more processors, such as the controller/processor 240, and in some aspects in conjunction with processor-readable code stored in the memory 242, to perform aspects of the methods, processes, and/or operations described herein. In some aspects, the network node 110 may include one or more interfaces, communication components, and/or other components that facilitate communication with the UE 120 or another network node.

[0063] The terms “processor,” “controller,” or “controller/processor” may refer to one or more controllers and/or one or more processors. For example, reference to “a/the processor,” “a/the controller/processor,” or the like (in the singular) should be understood to refer to any one or more of the processors described in connection with FIG. 2, such as a single processor or a combination of multiple different processors. Reference to “one or more processors” should be understood to refer to any one or more of the processors described in connection with FIG. 2. For example, one or more processors of the network node 110 may include transmit processor 214, TX MIMO processor 216, MIMO detector 236, receive processor 238, and/or controller/processor 240. Similarly, one or more processors of the UE 120 may include MIMO detector 256, receive processor 258, transmit processor 264, TX MIMO processor 266, and/or controller/processor 280.

[0064] In some aspects, a single processor may perform all of the operations described as being performed by the one or more processors. In some aspects, a first set of (one or more) processors of the one or more processors may perform a first operation described as being performed by the one or more processors, and a second set of (one or more) processors of the one or more processors may perform a second operation described as being performed by the one or more processors. The first set of processors and the second set of processors may be the same set of processors or may be different sets of processors. Reference to “one or more memories” should be understood to refer to any one or more memories of a corresponding device, such as the memory described in connection with FIG. 2. For example, operation described as being performed by one or more memories can be performed by the same subset of the one or more memories or different subsets of the one or more memories.

[0065] For downlink communication from the network node 110 to the UE 120, the transmit processor 214 may

receive data (“downlink data”) intended for the UE 120 (or a set of UEs that includes the UE 120) from the data source 212 (such as a data pipeline or a data queue). In some examples, the transmit processor 214 may select one or more MCSs for the UE 120 in accordance with one or more channel quality indicators (CQIs) received from the UE 120. The network node 110 may process the data (for example, including encoding the data) for transmission to the UE 120 on a downlink in accordance with the MCS(s) selected for the UE 120 to generate data symbols. The transmit processor 214 may process system information (for example, semi-static resource partitioning information (SRPI)) and/or control information (for example, CQI requests, grants, and/or upper layer signaling) and provide overhead symbols and/or control symbols. The transmit processor 214 may generate reference symbols for reference signals (for example, a cell-specific reference signal (CRS), a DMRS, or a channel state information (CSI) reference signal (CSI-RS)) and/or synchronization signals (for example, a primary synchronization signal (PSS) or a secondary synchronization signals (SSS)).

[0066] The TX MIMO processor 216 may perform spatial processing (for example, precoding) on the data symbols, the control symbols, the overhead symbols, and/or the reference symbols, if applicable, and may provide a set of output symbol streams (for example, T output symbol streams) to the set of modems 232. For example, each output symbol stream may be provided to a respective modulator component (shown as MOD) of a modem 232. Each modem 232 may use the respective modulator component to process (for example, to modulate) a respective output symbol stream (for example, for orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM)) to obtain an output sample stream. Each modem 232 may further use the respective modulator component to process (for example, convert to analog, amplify, filter, and/or upconvert) the output sample stream to obtain a time domain downlink signal. The modems 232a through 232t may together transmit a set of downlink signals (for example, T downlink signals) via the corresponding set of antennas 234.

[0067] A downlink signal may include a DCI communication, a MAC control element (MAC-CE) communication, an RRC communication, a downlink reference signal, or another type of downlink communication. Downlink signals may be transmitted on a PDCCH, a PDSCH, and/or on another downlink channel. A downlink signal may carry one or more transport blocks (TBs) of data. A TB may be a unit of data that is transmitted over an air interface in the wireless communication network 100. A data stream (for example, from the data source 212) may be encoded into multiple TBs for transmission over the air interface. The quantity of TBs used to carry the data associated with a particular data stream may be associated with a TB size common to the multiple TBs. The TB size may be based on or otherwise associated with radio channel conditions of the air interface, the MCS used for encoding the data, the downlink resources allocated for transmitting the data, and/or another parameter. In general, the larger the TB size, the greater the amount of data that can be transmitted in a single transmission, which reduces signaling overhead. However, larger TB sizes may be more prone to transmission and/or reception errors than smaller TB sizes, but such errors may be mitigated by more robust error correction techniques.

[0068] For uplink communication from the UE 120 to the network node 110, uplink signals from the UE 120 may be received by an antenna 234, may be processed by a modem 232 (for example, a demodulator component, shown as DEMOD, of a modem 232), may be detected by the MIMO detector 236 (for example, a receive (Rx) MIMO processor) if applicable, and/or may be further processed by the receive processor 238 to obtain decoded data and/or control information. The receive processor 238 may provide the decoded data to a data sink 239 (which may be a data pipeline, a data queue, and/or another type of data sink) and provide the decoded control information to a processor, such as the controller/processor 240.

[0069] The network node 110 may use the scheduler 246 to schedule one or more UEs 120 for downlink or uplink communications. In some aspects, the scheduler 246 may use DCI to dynamically schedule DL transmissions to the UE 120 and/or UL transmissions from the UE 120. In some examples, the scheduler 246 may allocate recurring time domain resources and/or frequency domain resources that the UE 120 may use to transmit and/or receive communications using an RRC configuration (for example, a semi-static configuration), for example, to perform semi-persistent scheduling (SPS) or to configure a configured grant (CG) for the UE 120.

[0070] One or more of the transmit processor 214, the TX MIMO processor 216, the modem 232, the antenna 234, the MIMO detector 236, the receive processor 238, and/or the controller/processor 240 may be included in an RF chain of the network node 110. An RF chain may include one or more filters, mixers, oscillators, amplifiers, analog-to-digital converters (ADCs), and/or other devices that convert between an analog signal (such as for transmission or reception via an air interface) and a digital signal (such as for processing by one or more processors of the network node 110). In some aspects, the RF chain may be or may be included in a transceiver of the network node 110.

[0071] In some examples, the network node 110 may use the communication unit 244 to communicate with a core network and/or with other network nodes. The communication unit 244 may support wired and/or wireless communication protocols and/or connections, such as Ethernet, optical fiber, common public radio interface (CPRI), and/or a wired or wireless backhaul, among other examples. The network node 110 may use the communication unit 244 to transmit and/or receive data associated with the UE 120 or to perform network control signaling, among other examples. The communication unit 244 may include a transceiver and/or an interface, such as a network interface.

[0072] The UE 120 may include a set of antennas 252 (shown as antennas 252a through 252r, where $r \geq 1$), a set of modems 254 (shown as modems 254a through 254u, where $u \geq 1$), a MIMO detector 256, a receive processor 258, a data sink 260, a data source 262, a transmit processor 264, a TX MIMO processor 266, a controller/processor 280, a memory 282, and/or a communication manager 140, among other examples. One or more of the components of the UE 120 may be included in a housing 284. In some aspects, one or a combination of the antenna(s) 252, the modem(s) 254, the MIMO detector 256, the receive processor 258, the transmit processor 264, or the TX MIMO processor 266 may be included in a transceiver that is included in the UE 120. The transceiver may be under control of and used by one or more processors, such as the controller/processor 280, and in

some aspects in conjunction with processor-readable code stored in the memory 282, to perform aspects of the methods, processes, or operations described herein. In some aspects, the UE 120 may include another interface, another communication component, and/or another component that facilitates communication with the network node 110 and/or another UE 120.

[0073] For downlink communication from the network node 110 to the UE 120, the set of antennas 252 may receive the downlink communications or signals from the network node 110 and may provide a set of received downlink signals (for example, R received signals) to the set of modems 254. For example, each received signal may be provided to a respective demodulator component (shown as DEMOD) of a modem 254. Each modem 254 may use the respective demodulator component to condition (for example, filter, amplify, downconvert, and/or digitize) a received signal to obtain input samples. Each modem 254 may use the respective demodulator component to further demodulate or process the input samples (for example, for OFDM) to obtain received symbols. The MIMO detector 256 may obtain received symbols from the set of modems 254, may perform MIMO detection on the received symbols if applicable, and may provide detected symbols. The receive processor 258 may process (for example, decode) the detected symbols, may provide decoded data for the UE 120 to the data sink 260 (which may include a data pipeline, a data queue, and/or an application executed on the UE 120), and may provide decoded control information and system information to the controller/processor 280.

[0074] For uplink communication from the UE 120 to the network node 110, the transmit processor 264 may receive and process data ("uplink data") from a data source 262 (such as a data pipeline, a data queue, and/or an application executed on the UE 120) and control information from the controller/processor 280. The control information may include one or more parameters, feedback, one or more signal measurements, and/or other types of control information. In some aspects, the receive processor 258 and/or the controller/processor 280 may determine, for a received signal (such as received from the network node 110 or another UE), one or more parameters relating to transmission of the uplink communication. The one or more parameters may include a reference signal received power (RSRP) parameter, a received signal strength indicator (RSSI) parameter, a reference signal received quality (RSRQ) parameter, a CQI parameter, or a transmit power control (TPC) parameter, among other examples. The control information may include an indication of the RSRP parameter, the RSSI parameter, the RSRQ parameter, the CQI parameter, the TPC parameter, and/or another parameter. The control information may facilitate parameter selection and/or scheduling for the UE 120 by the network node 110.

[0075] The transmit processor 264 may generate reference symbols for one or more reference signals, such as an uplink DMRS, an uplink sounding reference signal (SRS), and/or another type of reference signal. The symbols from the transmit processor 264 may be precoded by the TX MIMO processor 266, if applicable, and further processed by the set of modems 254 (for example, for DFT-s-OFDM or CP-OFDM). The TX MIMO processor 266 may perform spatial processing (for example, precoding) on the data symbols, the control symbols, the overhead symbols, and/or the reference symbols, if applicable, and may provide a set of

output symbol streams (for example, U output symbol streams) to the set of modems 254. For example, each output symbol stream may be provided to a respective modulator component (shown as MOD) of a modem 254. Each modem 254 may use the respective modulator component to process (for example, to modulate) a respective output symbol stream (for example, for OFDM) to obtain an output sample stream. Each modem 254 may further use the respective modulator component to process (for example, convert to analog, amplify, filter, and/or upconvert) the output sample stream to obtain an uplink signal.

[0076] The modems 254a through 254u may transmit a set of uplink signals (for example, R uplink signals or U uplink symbols) via the corresponding set of antennas 252. An uplink signal may include a UCI communication, a MAC-CE communication, an RRC communication, or another type of uplink communication. Uplink signals may be transmitted on a PUSCH, a PUCCH, and/or another type of uplink channel. An uplink signal may carry one or more TBs of data. Sidelink data and control transmissions (that is, transmissions directly between two or more UEs 120) may generally use similar techniques as were described for uplink data and control transmission, and may use sidelink-specific channels such as a physical sidelink shared channel (PSSCH), a physical sidelink control channel (PSCCH), and/or a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH).

[0077] One or more antennas of the set of antennas 252 or the set of antennas 234 may include, or may be included within, one or more antenna panels, one or more antenna groups, one or more sets of antenna elements, or one or more antenna arrays, among other examples. An antenna panel, an antenna group, a set of antenna elements, or an antenna array may include one or more antenna elements (within a single housing or multiple housings), a set of coplanar antenna elements, a set of non-coplanar antenna elements, or one or more antenna elements coupled with one or more transmission or reception components, such as one or more components of FIG. 2. As used herein, “antenna” can refer to one or more antennas, one or more antenna panels, one or more antenna groups, one or more sets of antenna elements, or one or more antenna arrays. “Antenna panel” can refer to a group of antennas (such as antenna elements) arranged in an array or panel, which may facilitate beamforming by manipulating parameters of the group of antennas. “Antenna module” may refer to circuitry including one or more antennas, which may also include one or more other components (such as filters, amplifiers, or processors) associated with integrating the antenna module into a wireless communication device.

[0078] In some examples, each of the antenna elements of an antenna 234 or an antenna 252 may include one or more sub-elements for radiating or receiving radio frequency signals. For example, a single antenna element may include a first sub-element cross-polarized with a second sub-element that can be used to independently transmit cross-polarized signals. The antenna elements may include patch antennas, dipole antennas, and/or other types of antennas arranged in a linear pattern, a two-dimensional pattern, or another pattern. A spacing between antenna elements may be such that signals with a desired wavelength transmitted separately by the antenna elements may interact or interfere constructively and destructively along various directions (such as to form a desired beam). For example, given an expected range of wavelengths or frequencies, the spacing may provide a quarter wavelength, a half wavelength, or

another fraction of a wavelength of spacing between neighboring antenna elements to allow for the desired constructive and destructive interference patterns of signals transmitted by the separate antenna elements within that expected range.

[0079] The amplitudes and/or phases of signals transmitted via antenna elements and/or sub-elements may be modulated and shifted relative to each other (such as by manipulating phase shift, phase offset, and/or amplitude) to generate one or more beams, which is referred to as beamforming. The term “beam” may refer to a directional transmission of a wireless signal toward a receiving device or otherwise in a desired direction. “Beam” may also generally refer to a direction associated with such a directional signal transmission, a set of directional resources associated with the signal transmission (for example, an angle of arrival, a horizontal direction, and/or a vertical direction), and/or a set of parameters that indicate one or more aspects of a directional signal, a direction associated with the signal, and/or a set of directional resources associated with the signal. In some implementations, antenna elements may be individually selected or deselected for directional transmission of a signal (or signals) by controlling amplitudes of one or more corresponding amplifiers and/or phases of the signal(s) to form one or more beams. The shape of a beam (such as the amplitude, width, and/or presence of side lobes) and/or the direction of a beam (such as an angle of the beam relative to a surface of an antenna array) can be dynamically controlled by modifying the phase shifts, phase offsets, and/or amplitudes of the multiple signals relative to each other.

[0080] Different UEs 120 or network nodes 110 may include different numbers of antenna elements. For example, a UE 120 may include a single antenna element, two antenna elements, four antenna elements, eight antenna elements, or a different number of antenna elements. As another example, a network node 110 may include eight antenna elements, 24 antenna elements, 64 antenna elements, 128 antenna elements, or a different number of antenna elements. Generally, a larger number of antenna elements may provide increased control over parameters for beam generation relative to a smaller number of antenna elements, whereas a smaller number of antenna elements may be less complex to implement and may use less power than a larger number of antenna elements. Multiple antenna elements may support multiple-layer transmission, in which a first layer of a communication (which may include a first data stream) and a second layer of a communication (which may include a second data stream) are transmitted using the same time and frequency resources with spatial multiplexing.

[0081] While blocks in FIG. 2 are illustrated as distinct components, the functions described above with respect to the blocks may be implemented in a single hardware, software, or combination component or in various combinations of components. For example, the functions described with respect to the transmit processor 264, the receive processor 258, and/or the TX MIMO processor 266 may be performed by or under the control of the controller/processor 280.

[0082] FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating an example disaggregated base station architecture 300 in accordance with the present disclosure. One or more components of the example disaggregated base station architecture 300 may be, may include, or may be included in one or more network nodes (such one or more network nodes 110). The disaggregated

base station architecture 300 may include a CU 310 that can communicate directly with a core network 320 via a backhaul link, or that can communicate indirectly with the core network 320 via one or more disaggregated control units, such as a Non-RT RIC 350 associated with a Service Management and Orchestration (SMO) Framework 360 and/or a Near-RT RIC 370 (for example, via an E2 link). The CU 310 may communicate with one or more DUs 330 via respective midhaul links, such as via F1 interfaces. Each of the DUs 330 may communicate with one or more RUs 340 via respective fronthaul links. Each of the RUs 340 may communicate with one or more UEs 120 via respective RF access links. In some deployments, a UE 120 may be simultaneously served by multiple RUs 340.

[0083] Each of the components of the disaggregated base station architecture 300, including the CU 310, the DUs 330, the RUs 340, the Near-RT RICs 370, the Non-RT RICs 350, and the SMO Framework 360, may include one or more interfaces or may be coupled with one or more interfaces for receiving or transmitting signals, such as data or information, via a wired or wireless transmission medium.

[0084] In some aspects, the CU 310 may be logically split into one or more CU user plane (CU-UP) units and one or more CU control plane (CU-CP) units. A CU-UP unit may communicate bidirectionally with a CU-CP unit via an interface, such as the E1 interface when implemented in an O-RAN configuration. The CU 310 may be deployed to communicate with one or more DUs 330, as necessary, for network control and signaling. Each DU 330 may correspond to a logical unit that includes one or more base station functions to control the operation of one or more RUs 340. For example, a DU 330 may host various layers, such as an RLC layer, a MAC layer, or one or more PHY layers, such as one or more high PHY layers or one or more low PHY layers. Each layer (which also may be referred to as a module) may be implemented with an interface for communicating signals with other layers (and modules) hosted by the DU 330, or for communicating signals with the control functions hosted by the CU 310. Each RU 340 may implement lower layer functionality. In some aspects, real-time and non-real-time aspects of control and user plane communication with the RU(s) 340 may be controlled by the corresponding DU 330.

[0085] The SMO Framework 360 may support RAN deployment and provisioning of non-virtualized and virtualized network elements. For non-virtualized network elements, the SMO Framework 360 may support the deployment of dedicated physical resources for RAN coverage requirements, which may be managed via an operations and maintenance interface, such as an O1 interface. For virtualized network elements, the SMO Framework 360 may interact with a cloud computing platform (such as an open cloud (O-Cloud) platform 390) to perform network element life cycle management (such as to instantiate virtualized network elements) via a cloud computing platform interface, such as an O2 interface. A virtualized network element may include, but is not limited to, a CU 310, a DU 330, an RU 340, a non-RT RIC 350, and/or a Near-RT RIC 370. In some aspects, the SMO Framework 360 may communicate with a hardware aspect of a 4G RAN, a 5G NR RAN, and/or a 6G RAN, such as an open eNB (O-eNB) 380, via an O1 interface. Additionally or alternatively, the SMO Framework 360 may communicate directly with each of one or more RUs 340 via a respective O1 interface. In some deploy-

ments, this configuration can enable each DU 330 and the CU 310 to be implemented in a cloud-based RAN architecture, such as a vRAN architecture.

[0086] The Non-RT RIC 350 may include or may implement a logical function that enables non-real-time control and optimization of RAN elements and resources, AI/ML workflows including model training and updates, and/or policy-based guidance of applications and/or features in the Near-RT RIC 370. The Non-RT RIC 350 may be coupled to or may communicate with (such as via an A1 interface) the Near-RT RIC 370. The Near-RT RIC 370 may include or may implement a logical function that enables near-real-time control and optimization of RAN elements and resources via data collection and actions via an interface (such as via an E2 interface) connecting one or more CUs 310, one or more DUs 330, and/or an O-eNB with the Near-RT RIC 370.

[0087] In some aspects, to generate AI/ML models to be deployed in the Near-RT RIC 370, the Non-RT RIC 350 may receive parameters or external enrichment information from external servers. Such information may be utilized by the Near-RT RIC 370 and may be received at the SMO Framework 360 or the Non-RT RIC 350 from non-network data sources or from network functions. In some examples, the Non-RT RIC 350 or the Near-RT RIC 370 may tune RAN behavior or performance. For example, the Non-RT RIC 350 may monitor long-term trends and patterns for performance and may employ AI/ML models to perform corrective actions via the SMO Framework 360 (such as reconfiguration via an O1 interface) or via creation of RAN management policies (such as A1 interface policies).

[0088] As indicated above, FIG. 3 is provided as an example. Other examples may differ from what is described with regard to FIG. 3.

[0089] The network node 110, the controller/processor 240 of the network node 110, the UE 120, the controller/processor 280 of the UE 120, the CU 310, the DU 330, the RU 340, or any other component(s) of FIG. 1, 2, or 3 may implement one or more techniques or perform one or more operations associated with an indication of non-causal cross-slot DMRS combining, as described in more detail elsewhere herein. For example, the controller/processor 240 of the network node 110, the controller/processor 280 of the UE 120, any other component(s) of FIG. 2, the CU 310, the DU 330, or the RU 340 may perform or direct operations of, for example, process 800 of FIG. 8, process 900 of FIG. 9, or other processes as described herein (alone or in conjunction with one or more other processors). The memory 242 may store data and program codes for the network node 110, the network node 110, the CU 310, the DU 330, or the RU 340. The memory 282 may store data and program codes for the UE 120. In some examples, the memory 242 or the memory 282 may include a non-transitory computer-readable medium storing a set of instructions (for example, code or program code) for wireless communication. The memory 242 may include one or more memories, such as a single memory or multiple different memories (of the same type or of different types). The memory 282 may include one or more memories, such as a single memory or multiple different memories (of the same type or of different types). For example, the set of instructions, when executed (for example, directly, or after compiling, converting, or interpreting) by one or more processors of the network node 110, the UE 120, the CU 310, the DU 330, or the RU 340, may

cause the one or more processors to perform process 800 of FIG. 8, process 900 of FIG. 9, or other processes as described herein. In some examples, executing instructions may include running the instructions, converting the instructions, compiling the instructions, and/or interpreting the instructions, among other examples.

[0090] In some aspects, a UE (e.g., a UE 120) includes means for receiving an indication of whether the UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation; and/or means for performing the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication. The means for the UE to perform operations described herein may include, for example, one or more of communication manager 140, antenna 252, modem 254, MIMO detector 256, receive processor 258, transmit processor 264, TX MIMO processor 266, controller/processor 280, or memory 282.

[0091] In some aspects, a network entity (e.g., network node 110) includes means for generating an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation; and/or means for transmitting the indication. In some aspects, the means for the network entity to perform operations described herein may include, for example, one or more of communication manager 150, transmit processor 214, TX MIMO processor 216, modem 232, antenna 234, MIMO detector 236, receive processor 238, controller/processor 240, memory 242, or scheduler 246.

[0092] As indicated above, FIG. 3 is provided as an example. Other examples may differ from what is described with regard to FIG. 3.

[0093] FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating an example 400 of causal cross-slot combining, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0094] A UE may measure a DMRS in a downlink message to estimate a channel. The UE may obtain a more accurate channel estimate if the DMRS is jointly estimated with another DMRS of another TTI. In some aspects, the UE may use causal cross-slot DMRS combining for channel estimation, in which the UE buffers the DMRS and/or channel estimates from a previous slot $n-1$ and uses the previous DMRS and/or channel estimates and a DMRS of current slot n to jointly estimate the channel. Example 400 shows cross-slot DMRS combining, where the joint channel estimation is based on combining DMRSs across slots. The combining is considered “causal” because the combining involves a past DMRS. Causal cross-slot DMRS combining may save DMRS overhead in a mobility scenario in which a network entity can allocate one DMRS while asking the UE to exploit the DMRS from previous slots.

[0095] However, for the first downlink slot of the burst, the receiving UE may not have the DMRS from a previous slot for combining. Furthermore, if the only DMRS is front loaded (e.g., placed in one of the first few symbols of a slot), combining with a front-loaded DMRS in the previous slot in causal cross-slot DMRS combining may lead to the extrapolation of channel estimates in the current TTI. This extrapolation may not be as accurate as interpolation, because extrapolation involves estimating an unknown value beyond the DMRSs, while interpolation involves estimating a value within the DMRSs.

[0096] As indicated above, FIG. 4 is provided as an example. Other examples may differ from what is described with regard to FIG. 4.

[0097] FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating an example 500 of non-causal cross-slot combining, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0098] In some aspects, a UE may perform non-causal cross-slot DMRS combining for joint channel estimation, which involves a DMRS of a future TTI (future slot). Example 500 shows that the receiving UE may wait for the next front-loaded DMRS in the next TTI (slot $n+1$) and perform joint channel estimation, which for the current TTI (slot n) may include time interpolation. In a high mobility scenario, with a configuration of one DMRS per slot (overhead saving), the cross-slot DMRS combining may provide substantial gains. The placement of DMRS or the selection of non-causal over causal cross-slot DMRS combining for time domain interpolation may offer an additional 10% throughput gain over extrapolation. FIG. 4 shows extrapolation of PDSCH symbols (beyond the DMRSs), and FIG. 5 shows interpolation of PDSCH symbols (between the DMRSs).

[0099] For non-causal DMRS cross slot combining, a UE may expect that there is a next slot for combining, and the UE may perform DMRS detection in the next slot to decide whether to combine DMRSs. However, this could seriously delay the UE PDSCH decoding timeline. That is, the UE may expect to wait for the DMRS in the next slot before completing the joint channel estimation and the PDSCH decoding. This could adversely consume the processing time budget of the UE that is part of the processing time K_1 , especially for a multi-carrier case or a 400 megahertz (MHz) case.

[0100] In some aspects, to combine the DMRS in the next slot for joint channel estimation, the receiving UE may expect a combinable DMRS in the next slot, and the actual cross-slot DMRS combining may be based on the DMRS/DCI detection in the next slot. The UE may have to delay the channel estimation and hence delay PDSCH decoding after receiving at least the first DMRS in the next slot. To avoid the case in which the UE always waits until the next slot for PDSCH decoding, some network entity signaling can be introduced. According to various aspects described herein, a network entity may indicate whether non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is possible with the next TTI (e.g., next slot). The network entity may also indicate combinable DMRS resources in the next slot. If the network entity indicates that cross-slot DMRS combining is possible, the network entity may commit to scheduling the next slot with the same precoding and/or the same TCI state.

[0101] In some aspects, the network entity may provide an indication (e.g., in DCI) of whether non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is possible in a next slot. The DCI may further indicate a port number, an FDRA, and/or which DMRS symbols in the next slot are combinable for non-causal cross-slot DMRS combining. Based at least in part on the indication, the UE may decide whether to delay the channel estimation, delay a PDSCH demapper (that demaps symbols to bits), and/or to delay a decoding timeline. By indicating whether DMRS combining is possible, the UE may perform joint channel estimation with cross-slot DMRS combining only when doing so is worth the use of the resources. As a result, latency is reduced and/or the UE processing timeline is not negatively impacted.

[0102] As indicated above, FIG. 5 is provided as an example. Other examples may differ from what is described with regard to FIG. 5.

[0103] FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating an example 600 of non-causal cross-slot combining, in accordance with the present disclosure.

[0104] In some aspects, for the next slot, the network entity may determine to transmit or not transmit based at least in part on the traffic. If the network entity determines to transmit a PDSCH message, the network entity may conform to a pre-committed precoder and DMRS resources such that the UE may perform non-causal cross-slot DMRS combining. If the network entity has no PDSCH message to transmit, for the next slot, the network entity may refrain from transmitting anything, and the UE may determine to perform cross-slot channel estimation based at least in part on blind DCI detection or blind DMRS detection in the next slot. Based at least in part on the DMRS detection or the DCI detection, the UE may determine whether to perform cross-slot channel estimation or a single slot legacy channel estimation.

[0105] In some aspects, for the next slot, even if the network entity has no PDSCH message to transmit, the UE may still transmit the DMRS that is pre-committed in the previous DCI, as shown by example 600. With the stand-alone DMRS, the UE may have DMRSs to combine in the next slot regardless of whether the network entity has transmitted a PDSCH message.

[0106] In some aspects, if the network entity determines to change a precoder for the next slot (performing MU-MIMO) or change an FDRA for frequency division multiplexing (FDMing) UEs, and if the UE blindly combines with the next slot, this can degrade channel estimation performance. In some aspects, the network entity may transmit DCI in the next slot to indicate that non-causal cross-slot DMRS combining is canceled. The UE may have to read the DCI to know that the DMRS combining is cancelled.

[0107] In some aspects, the UE may determine whether to combine DMRSs based at least in part on the DMRS detection in the next slot, because DCI detection may take more time. In such cases, the UE may select a different DMRS scrambling sequence for the next slot if the network entity determines to cancel the combining. In some aspects, in NR, the network entity may determine two different DMRS initial seeds and signal a DMRS sequence initialization field in DCI. The network entity may signal a DMRS sequence initialization field if the UE determines to change the precoder in the next slot.

[0108] As indicated above, FIG. 6 is provided as an example. Other examples may differ from what is described with regard to FIG. 6.

[0109] FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating an example 700 associated with indicating whether non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is to be performed, in accordance with the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 7, a network entity 710 (e.g., network node 110) and a UE 720 (e.g., UE 120) may communicate with one another.

[0110] As shown by reference number 725, the network entity 710 may generate an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. As shown by reference number 730, the network entity 710 may transmit the indication. The network entity 710 may transmit the indication in DCI. In some aspects, the indication indicates combinable resources in the future slot. The combinable resources may include a port number, a frequency domain resource allocation, and/or DMRS symbols. As

shown by reference number 735, the UE 720 may perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication. As shown by reference number 740, the UE 720 may transmit a channel estimate.

[0111] In some aspects, a TCI state of a future slot and a TCI state of the current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining. In some aspects, the network entity 710 may schedule the future slot with the same precoding or TCI state as the current slot. In some aspects, a precoding of the future slot and a precoding of a current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0112] In some aspects, the indication indicates that non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is canceled for the future slot. As shown by reference number 745, if the network entity 710 decides to cancel the combining, the UE 720 may select a DMRS scrambling sequence for the future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot. The network entity 710 may select two different DMRS initial seeds. The network entity 710 may indicate a DMRS sequence initialization field in the DCI. The network entity 710 may also select a different DMRS scrambling sequence for the future slot if the network entity 710 decides to change the precoder in the future slot.

[0113] In some aspects, the UE 720 may delay a timeline of the joint channel estimation, a timeline of a physical downlink shared channel demapper, or a timeline of a decoding based at least in part on the indication. Delaying a timeline may include starting later (e.g., at a later slot). In some aspects, the UE 720 may perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on a blind detection of DCI in the future slot or a blind detection of a DMRS in the future slot.

[0114] In some aspects, as shown by reference number 750, the network entity 710 may refrain from transmitting a PDSCH message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit. In some aspects, as shown by reference number 755, the network entity 710 may transmit a stand-alone DMRS without a PDSCH message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit. The UE 720 may jointly estimate the channel using the standalone DMRS on a pre-committed resource (e.g., symbol) of the future slot and with the same precoder as a previous slot. By not changing the precoder, the UE may not degrade the performance of the channel estimation. A more accurate channel estimate improves the scheduling by the network entity for better communications, which conserves signaling resources.

[0115] As indicated above, FIG. 7 is provided as an example. Other examples may differ from what is described with respect to FIG. 7.

[0116] FIG. 8 is a diagram illustrating an example process 800 performed, for example, at a UE or an apparatus of a UE, in accordance with the present disclosure. Example process 800 is an example where the apparatus or the UE (e.g., UE 120, UE 720) performs operations associated with an indication for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0117] As shown in FIG. 8, in some aspects, process 800 may include receiving an indication of whether the UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation (block

810). For example, the UE (e.g., using reception component **1002** and/or communication manager **1006**, depicted in FIG. **10**) may receive an indication of whether the UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation, as described above.

[0118] As further shown in FIG. **8**, in some aspects, process **800** may include performing the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication (block **820**). For example, the UE (e.g., using communication manager **1006**, depicted in FIG. **10**) may perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication, as described above.

[0119] Process **800** may include additional aspects, such as any single aspect or any combination of aspects described below and/or in connection with one or more other processes described elsewhere herein.

[0120] In a first aspect, the indication indicates that non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is canceled for the future slot.

[0121] In a second aspect, alone or in combination with the first aspect, the indication is included in DCI.

[0122] In a third aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first and second aspects, process **800** includes selecting a DMRS scrambling sequence for the future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot.

[0123] In a fourth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through third aspects, the indication indicates combinable resources in the future slot.

[0124] In a fifth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through fourth aspects, a TCI state of the future slot and a TCI state of a current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0125] In a sixth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through fifth aspects, a precoding of the future slot and a precoding of a current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0126] In a seventh aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through sixth aspects, process **800** includes delaying a timeline of the joint channel estimation, a timeline of a PDSCH demapper, or a timeline of a decoding based at least in part on the indication.

[0127] In an eighth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through seventh aspects, performing the joint channel estimation includes performing the joint channel estimation based at least in part on a blind detection of DCI in the future slot or a blind detection of a DMRS in the future slot.

[0128] Although FIG. **8** shows example blocks of process **800**, in some aspects, process **800** may include additional blocks, fewer blocks, different blocks, or differently arranged blocks than those depicted in FIG. **8**. Additionally, or alternatively, two or more of the blocks of process **800** may be performed in parallel.

[0129] FIG. **9** is a diagram illustrating an example process **900** performed, for example, at a network entity or an apparatus of a network entity, in accordance with the present disclosure. Example process **900** is an example where the apparatus or the network entity (e.g., network node **110**,

network entity **710**) performs operations associated with an indication for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0130] As shown in FIG. **9**, in some aspects, process **900** may include generating an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation (block **910**). For example, the network entity (e.g., using communication manager **1106**, depicted in FIG. **11**) may generate an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation, as described above.

[0131] As further shown in FIG. **9**, in some aspects, process **900** may include transmitting the indication (block **920**). For example, the network entity (e.g., using transmission component **1104** and/or communication manager **1106**, depicted in FIG. **11**) may transmit the indication, as described above.

[0132] Process **900** may include additional aspects, such as any single aspect or any combination of aspects described below and/or in connection with one or more other processes described elsewhere herein.

[0133] In a first aspect, the indication indicates that non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is canceled for the future slot.

[0134] In a second aspect, alone or in combination with the first aspect, the indication is included in DCI.

[0135] In a third aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first and second aspects, process **900** includes selecting a DMRS scrambling sequence for a future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot.

[0136] In a fourth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through third aspects, the indication indicates combinable resources in the future slot, and the combinable resources include one or more of a port number, an FDRA, or DMRS symbols.

[0137] In a fifth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through fourth aspects, process **900** includes scheduling the future slot with a same precoding or TCI state as a current slot.

[0138] In a sixth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through fifth aspects, process **900** includes refraining from transmitting a PDSCH message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit.

[0139] In a seventh aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through sixth aspects, process **900** includes transmitting a standalone DMRS without a PDSCH message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit.

[0140] In an eighth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through seventh aspects, a precoding of the future slot and a precoding of a current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0141] Although FIG. **9** shows example blocks of process **900**, in some aspects, process **900** may include additional blocks, fewer blocks, different blocks, or differently arranged blocks than those depicted in FIG. **9**. Additionally, or alternatively, two or more of the blocks of process **900** may be performed in parallel.

[0142] FIG. **10** is a diagram of an example apparatus **1000** for wireless communication, in accordance with the present disclosure. The apparatus **1000** may be a UE, or a UE may

include the apparatus **1000**. In some aspects, the apparatus **1000** includes a reception component **1002**, a transmission component **1004**, and/or a communication manager **1006**, which may be in communication with one another (for example, via one or more buses and/or one or more other components). In some aspects, the communication manager **1006** is the communication manager **140** described in connection with FIG. 1. As shown, the apparatus **1000** may communicate with another apparatus **1008**, such as a UE or a network node (such as a CU, a DU, an RU, or a base station), using the reception component **1002** and the transmission component **1004**.

[0143] In some aspects, the apparatus **1000** may be configured to perform one or more operations described herein in connection with FIGS. 1-7. Additionally, or alternatively, the apparatus **1000** may be configured to perform one or more processes described herein, such as process **800** of FIG. 8. In some aspects, the apparatus **1000** and/or one or more components shown in FIG. 10 may include one or more components of the UE described in connection with FIG. 2. Additionally, or alternatively, one or more components shown in FIG. 10 may be implemented within one or more components described in connection with FIG. 2. Additionally, or alternatively, one or more components of the set of components may be implemented at least in part as software stored in one or more memories. For example, a component (or a portion of a component) may be implemented as instructions or code stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium and executable by one or more controllers or one or more processors to perform the functions or operations of the component.

[0144] The reception component **1002** may receive communications, such as reference signals, control information, data communications, or a combination thereof, from the apparatus **1008**. The reception component **1002** may provide received communications to one or more other components of the apparatus **1000**. In some aspects, the reception component **1002** may perform signal processing on the received communications (such as filtering, amplification, demodulation, analog-to-digital conversion, demultiplexing, deinterleaving, de-mapping, equalization, interference cancellation, or decoding, among other examples), and may provide the processed signals to the one or more other components of the apparatus **1000**. In some aspects, the reception component **1002** may include one or more antennas, one or more modems, one or more demodulators, one or more MIMO detectors, one or more receive processors, one or more controllers/processors, one or more memories, or a combination thereof, of the UE described in connection with FIG. 2.

[0145] The transmission component **1004** may transmit communications, such as reference signals, control information, data communications, or a combination thereof, to the apparatus **1008**. In some aspects, one or more other components of the apparatus **1000** may generate communications and may provide the generated communications to the transmission component **1004** for transmission to the apparatus **1008**. In some aspects, the transmission component **1004** may perform signal processing on the generated communications (such as filtering, amplification, modulation, digital-to-analog conversion, multiplexing, interleaving, mapping, or encoding, among other examples), and may transmit the processed signals to the apparatus **1008**. In some aspects, the transmission component **1004** may

include one or more antennas, one or more modems, one or more modulators, one or more transmit MIMO processors, one or more transmit processors, one or more controllers/processors, one or more memories, or a combination thereof, of the UE described in connection with FIG. 2. In some aspects, the transmission component **1004** may be co-located with the reception component **1002** in one or more transceivers.

[0146] The communication manager **1006** may support operations of the reception component **1002** and/or the transmission component **1004**. For example, the communication manager **1006** may receive information associated with configuring reception of communications by the reception component **1002** and/or transmission of communications by the transmission component **1004**. Additionally, or alternatively, the communication manager **1006** may generate and/or provide control information to the reception component **1002** and/or the transmission component **1004** to control reception and/or transmission of communications.

[0147] The reception component **1002** may receive an indication of whether the UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The communication manager **1006** may perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication.

[0148] The communication manager **1006** may select a DMRS scrambling sequence for the future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot. The communication manager **1006** may delay a timeline of the joint channel estimation, a timeline of a PDSCH demapper, or a timeline of a decoding based at least in part on the indication.

[0149] The number and arrangement of components shown in FIG. 10 are provided as an example. In practice, there may be additional components, fewer components, different components, or differently arranged components than those shown in FIG. 10. Furthermore, two or more components shown in FIG. 10 may be implemented within a single component, or a single component shown in FIG. 10 may be implemented as multiple, distributed components. Additionally, or alternatively, a set of (one or more) components shown in FIG. 10 may perform one or more functions described as being performed by another set of components shown in FIG. 10.

[0150] FIG. 11 is a diagram of an example apparatus **1100** for wireless communication, in accordance with the present disclosure. The apparatus **1100** may be a network entity, or a network entity may include the apparatus **1100**. In some aspects, the apparatus **1100** includes a reception component **1102**, a transmission component **1104**, and/or a communication manager **1106**, which may be in communication with one another (for example, via one or more buses and/or one or more other components). In some aspects, the communication manager **1106** is the communication manager **1106** described in connection with FIG. 1. As shown, the apparatus **1100** may communicate with another apparatus **1108**, such as a UE or a network node (such as a CU, a DU, an RU, or a base station), using the reception component **1102** and the transmission component **1104**.

[0151] In some aspects, the apparatus **1100** may be configured to perform one or more operations described herein in connection with FIGS. 1-7. Additionally, or alternatively, the apparatus **1100** may be configured to perform one or more processes described herein, such as process **900** of

FIG. 9. In some aspects, the apparatus 1100 and/or one or more components shown in FIG. 11 may include one or more components of the network entity described in connection with FIG. 2. Additionally, or alternatively, one or more components shown in FIG. 11 may be implemented within one or more components described in connection with FIG. 2. Additionally, or alternatively, one or more components of the set of components may be implemented at least in part as software stored in one or more memories. For example, a component (or a portion of a component) may be implemented as instructions or code stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium and executable by one or more controllers or one or more processors to perform the functions or operations of the component.

[0152] The reception component 1102 may receive communications, such as reference signals, control information, data communications, or a combination thereof, from the apparatus 1108. The reception component 1102 may provide received communications to one or more other components of the apparatus 1100. In some aspects, the reception component 1102 may perform signal processing on the received communications (such as filtering, amplification, demodulation, analog-to-digital conversion, demultiplexing, deinterleaving, de-mapping, equalization, interference cancellation, or decoding, among other examples), and may provide the processed signals to the one or more other components of the apparatus 1100. In some aspects, the reception component 1102 may include one or more antennas, one or more modems, one or more demodulators, one or more MIMO detectors, one or more receive processors, one or more controllers/processors, one or more memories, or a combination thereof, of the network entity described in connection with FIG. 2.

[0153] The transmission component 1104 may transmit communications, such as reference signals, control information, data communications, or a combination thereof, to the apparatus 1108. In some aspects, one or more other components of the apparatus 1100 may generate communications and may provide the generated communications to the transmission component 1104 for transmission to the apparatus 1108. In some aspects, the transmission component 1104 may perform signal processing on the generated communications (such as filtering, amplification, modulation, digital-to-analog conversion, multiplexing, interleaving, mapping, or encoding, among other examples), and may transmit the processed signals to the apparatus 1108. In some aspects, the transmission component 1104 may include one or more antennas, one or more modems, one or more modulators, one or more transmit MIMO processors, one or more transmit processors, one or more controllers/processors, one or more memories, or a combination thereof, of the network entity described in connection with FIG. 2. In some aspects, the transmission component 1104 may be co-located with the reception component 1102 in one or more transceivers.

[0154] The communication manager 1106 may support operations of the reception component 1102 and/or the transmission component 1104. For example, the communication manager 1106 may receive information associated with configuring reception of communications by the reception component 1102 and/or transmission of communications by the transmission component 1104. Additionally, or alternatively, the communication manager 1106 may generate and/or provide control information to the reception

component 1102 and/or the transmission component 1104 to control reception and/or transmission of communications.

[0155] The communication manager 1106 may generate an indication of whether a UE is able to use a DMRS in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation. The transmission component 1104 may transmit the indication.

[0156] The communication manager 1106 may select a DMRS scrambling sequence for a future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot. The communication manager 1106 may schedule the future slot with a same precoding or TCI state as a current slot. The communication manager 1106 may refrain from transmitting a PDSCH message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit.

[0157] The transmission component 1104 may transmit a standalone DMRS without a PDSCH message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit.

[0158] The number and arrangement of components shown in FIG. 11 are provided as an example. In practice, there may be additional components, fewer components, different components, or differently arranged components than those shown in FIG. 11. Furthermore, two or more components shown in FIG. 11 may be implemented within a single component, or a single component shown in FIG. 11 may be implemented as multiple, distributed components. Additionally, or alternatively, a set of (one or more) components shown in FIG. 11 may perform one or more functions described as being performed by another set of components shown in FIG. 11.

[0159] The following provides an overview of some Aspects of the present disclosure:

[0160] Aspect 1: A method of wireless communication performed by a user equipment (UE), comprising: receiving an indication of whether the UE is able to use a demodulation reference signal (DMRS) in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation; and performing the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication.

[0161] Aspect 2: The method of Aspect 1, wherein the indication indicates that non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is canceled for the future slot.

[0162] Aspect 3: The method of Aspect 2, wherein the indication is included in downlink control information.

[0163] Aspect 4: The method of Aspect 2, further comprising selecting a DMRS scrambling sequence for the future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot.

[0164] Aspect 5: The method of any of Aspects 1-4, wherein the indication indicates combinable resources in the future slot.

[0165] Aspect 6: The method of any of Aspects 1-5, wherein a transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state of the future slot and a TCI state of a current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0166] Aspect 7: The method of any of Aspects 1-6, wherein a precoding of the future slot and a precoding of a current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0167] Aspect 8: The method of any of Aspects 1-7, further comprising delaying a timeline of the joint channel

estimation, a timeline of a physical downlink shared channel demapper, or a timeline of a decoding based at least in part on the indication.

[0168] Aspect 9: The method of any of Aspects 1-8, wherein performing the joint channel estimation includes performing the joint channel estimation based at least in part on a blind detection of downlink control information in the future slot or a blind detection of a DMRS in the future slot.

[0169] Aspect 10: A method of wireless communication performed by a network entity, comprising: generating an indication of whether a user equipment (UE) is able to use a demodulation reference signal (DMRS) in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation; and transmitting the indication.

[0170] Aspect 11: The method of Aspect 10, wherein the indication indicates that non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is canceled for the future slot.

[0171] Aspect 12: The method of Aspect 11, wherein the indication is included in downlink control information.

[0172] Aspect 13: The method of Aspect 11, further comprising selecting a DMRS scrambling sequence for a future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot.

[0173] Aspect 14: The method of any of Aspects 10-13, wherein the indication indicates combinable resources in the future slot, and wherein the combinable resources include one or more of a port number, a frequency domain resource allocation, or DMRS symbols.

[0174] Aspect 15: The method of any of Aspects 10-14, further comprising scheduling the future slot with a same precoding or transmission configuration indicator state as a current slot.

[0175] Aspect 16: The method of any of Aspects 10-15, further comprising refraining from transmitting a physical downlink shared channel message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit.

[0176] Aspect 17: The method of any of Aspects 10-16, further comprising transmitting a standalone DMRS without a physical downlink shared channel message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit.

[0177] Aspect 18: The method of any of Aspects 10-17, wherein a precoding of the future slot and a precoding of a current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

[0178] Aspect 19: An apparatus for wireless communication at a device, the apparatus comprising one or more processors; one or more memories coupled with the one or more processors; and instructions stored in the one or more memories and executable by the one or more processors to cause the apparatus to perform the method of one or more of Aspects 1-18.

[0179] Aspect 20: An apparatus for wireless communication at a device, the apparatus comprising one or more memories and one or more processors coupled to the one or more memories, the one or more processors configured to cause the device to perform the method of one or more of Aspects 1-18.

[0180] Aspect 21: An apparatus for wireless communication, the apparatus comprising at least one means for performing the method of one or more of Aspects 1-18.

[0181] Aspect 22: A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing code for wireless communication, the code

comprising instructions executable by one or more processors to perform the method of one or more of Aspects 1-18.

[0182] Aspect 23: A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing a set of instructions for wireless communication, the set of instructions comprising one or more instructions that, when executed by one or more processors of a device, cause the device to perform the method of one or more of Aspects 1-18.

[0183] Aspect 24: A device for wireless communication, the device comprising a processing system that includes one or more processors and one or more memories coupled with the one or more processors, the processing system configured to cause the device to perform the method of one or more of Aspects 1-18.

[0184] Aspect 25: An apparatus for wireless communication at a device, the apparatus comprising one or more memories and one or more processors coupled to the one or more memories, the one or more processors individually or collectively configured to cause the device to perform the method of one or more of Aspects 1-18.

[0185] The foregoing disclosure provides illustration and description but is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the aspects to the precise forms disclosed.

[0186] Modifications and variations may be made in light of the above disclosure or may be acquired from practice of the aspects.

[0187] As used herein, the term “component” is intended to be broadly construed as hardware or a combination of hardware and at least one of software or firmware. “Software” shall be construed broadly to mean instructions, instruction sets, code, code segments, program code, programs, subprograms, software modules, applications, software applications, software packages, routines, subroutines, objects, executables, threads of execution, procedures, or functions, among other examples, whether referred to as software, firmware, middleware, microcode, hardware description language, or otherwise. As used herein, a “processor” is implemented in hardware or a combination of hardware and software. It will be apparent that systems or methods described herein may be implemented in different forms of hardware or a combination of hardware and software. The actual specialized control hardware or software code used to implement these systems or methods is not limiting of the aspects. Thus, the operation and behavior of the systems or methods are described herein without reference to specific software code, because those skilled in the art will understand that software and hardware can be designed to implement the systems or methods based, at least in part, on the description herein. A component being configured to perform a function means that the component has a capability to perform the function, and does not require the function to be actually performed by the component, unless noted otherwise.

[0188] As used herein, “satisfying a threshold” may, depending on the context, refer to a value being greater than the threshold, greater than or equal to the threshold, less than the threshold, less than or equal to the threshold, equal to the threshold, or not equal to the threshold, among other examples.

[0189] As used herein, a phrase referring to “at least one of” a list of items refers to any combination of those items, including single members. As an example, “at least one of: a, b, or c” is intended to cover a, b, c, a+b, a+c, b+c, and a+b+c, as well as any combination with multiples of the

same element (for example, a+a, a+a+a, a+a+b, a+a+c, a+b+b, a+c+c, b+b, b+b+b, b+b+c, c+c, and c+c+c, or any other ordering of a, b, and c).

[0190] No element, act, or instruction used herein should be construed as critical or essential unless explicitly described as such. Also, as used herein, the articles “a” and “an” are intended to include one or more items and may be used interchangeably with “one or more.” Further, as used herein, the article “the” is intended to include one or more items referenced in connection with the article “the” and may be used interchangeably with “the one or more.” Furthermore, as used herein, the terms “set” and “group” are intended to include one or more items and may be used interchangeably with “one or more.” Where only one item is intended, the phrase “only one” or similar language is used. Also, as used herein, the terms “has,” “have,” “having,” and similar terms are intended to be open-ended terms that do not limit an element that they modify (for example, an element “having” A may also have B). Further, the phrase “based on” is intended to mean “based on or otherwise in association with” unless explicitly stated otherwise. Also, as used herein, the term “or” is intended to be inclusive when used in a series and may be used interchangeably with “and/or,” unless explicitly stated otherwise (for example, if used in combination with “either” or “only one of”). It should be understood that “one or more” is equivalent to “at least one.”

[0191] Even though particular combinations of features are recited in the claims or disclosed in the specification, these combinations are not intended to limit the disclosure of various aspects. Many of these features may be combined in ways not specifically recited in the claims or disclosed in the specification. The disclosure of various aspects includes each dependent claim in combination with every other claim in the claim set.

What is claimed is:

1. An apparatus for wireless communication at a user equipment (UE), comprising:

one or more memories; and

one or more processors, coupled to the one or more memories, individually or collectively configured to cause the UE to:

receive an indication of whether the UE is able to use a demodulation reference signal (DMRS) in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation; and

perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication.

2. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the indication indicates that non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is canceled for the future slot.

3. The apparatus of claim 2, wherein the indication is included in downlink control information.

4. The apparatus of claim 2, wherein the one or more processors are individually or collectively configured to cause the UE to select a DMRS scrambling sequence for the future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot.

5. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the indication indicates combinable resources in the future slot.

6. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein a transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state of the future slot and a TCI state of a current slot are the same based at least in part

on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

7. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein a precoding of the future slot and a precoding of a current slot are the same based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

8. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the one or more processors are individually or collectively configured to cause the UE to delay a timeline of the joint channel estimation, a timeline of a physical downlink shared channel demapper, or a timeline of a decoding based at least in part on the indication.

9. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein to perform the joint channel estimation, the one or more processors are individually or collectively configured to cause the UE to perform the joint channel estimation based at least in part on a blind detection of downlink control information in the future slot or a blind detection of a DMRS in the future slot.

10. An apparatus for wireless communication at a network entity, comprising:

one or more memories; and

one or more processors, coupled to the one or more memories, individually or collectively configured to cause the network entity to:

generate an indication of whether a user equipment (UE) is able to use a demodulation reference signal (DMRS) in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation; and

transmit the indication.

11. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the indication indicates that non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is canceled for the future slot.

12. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the indication is included in downlink control information.

13. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the one or more processors are individually or collectively configured to cause the network entity to select a DMRS scrambling sequence for a future slot that is different than a DMRS scrambling sequence for a current slot.

14. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the indication indicates combinable resources in the future slot, and wherein the combinable resources include one or more of a port number, a frequency domain resource allocation, or DMRS symbols.

15. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the one or more processors are individually or collectively configured to cause the network entity to schedule the future slot with a same precoding or transmission configuration indicator state as a current slot.

16. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the one or more processors are individually or collectively configured to cause the network entity to refrain from transmitting a physical downlink shared channel message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit.

17. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the one or more processors are individually or collectively configured to cause the network entity to transmit a standalone DMRS without a physical downlink shared channel message based at least in part on there being no traffic to transmit.

18. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein a precoding of the future slot and a precoding of a current slot are the same

based at least in part on the indication indicating that the UE is able to use the DMRS in the future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining.

19. A method of wireless communication performed by a user equipment (UE), comprising:

receiving an indication of whether the UE is able to use a demodulation reference signal (DMRS) in a future slot for non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining for joint channel estimation; and
performing the joint channel estimation based at least in part on the indication.

20. The method of claim **19**, wherein the indication indicates that non-causal DMRS cross-slot combining is canceled for the future slot.

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